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Pension planning.
An all-round guide to NPS for first-time investors

BIG STORY P2



Policy moves.
A lowdown on the RBI's recent FCNR (B) swap window measure

YOUR MONEY P3

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The day all hedges fell in the US markets

TURBULENCE AHEAD. Markets grapple with the aftershocks of the AI sell-off, rising yields and mounting tensions in West Asia as fear grips investors

Kumar Shankar Roy
Hari Viswanath
bl. research bureau

Last Friday was a day when the logic of investing in uncorrelated assets broke down in the US markets. Most stocks fell, while semiconductor stocks crashed. Bonds declined as yields spiked. Gold and silver retreated. Crypto cracked. Crude oil slipped. The iShares MSCI South Korea ETF, traded in the US, tumbled 14.1 per cent (see table). The only thing that went up — and no, that is not a bullish sign — was the VIX or CBOE Volatility Index which shot up nearly 40 per cent, implying fear was the only winner.

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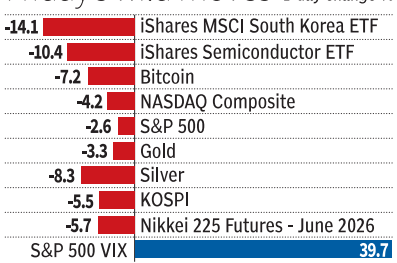
FEAR AND FRESH ISSUE

The trigger was not one shock but a pile-up. Results from Broadcom after market close on Wednesday triggered a rout in semiconductor stocks on Thursday and Friday. A solid 48 per cent year-on-year increase in its May quarter revenue was overshadowed by its July quarter outlook for AI chips, which fell short of investors' lofty expectations.

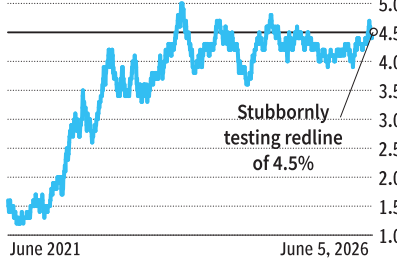
Further, on Friday, the release of US jobs data for May which solidly beat forecasts added fuel to expectations that the US Fed is now likely to get hawkish amid high inflation and good job market (negates need for rate cuts). This pushed bond yields higher, with the 10-year Treasury yield moving above 4.5 per cent. These factors hurt the two trades that had dominated 2026: Long AI and rate-cut bets. When expensive growth stocks meet rising yields, even good stories need fresh oxygen.

Furthermore, market sentiment has soured over concerns that Big Tech firms may pivot from being buyers of their own equity to net sellers, as they divert capital to fuel their relentless AI infrastructure build-out. Alphabet,

Friday's wild moves



US 10-year sovereign bond yield (%)



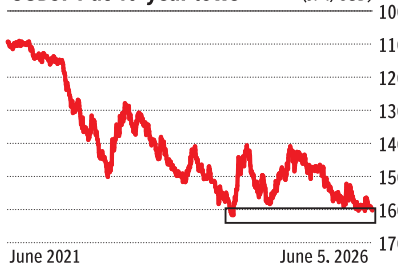
Source: Bloomberg

Google's parent, last week moved to raise nearly \$85 billion through an upsized equity plan to fund AI ambitions. On Friday, Facebook parent Meta's stock fell after reports said it could raise tens of billions of dollars for its own AI push, though the company called the report speculation.

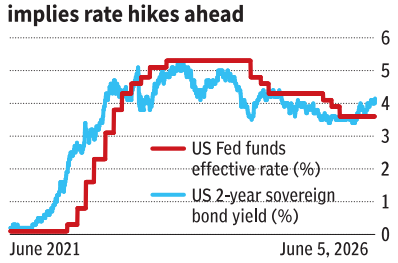
That shift matters. For years, cash-rich technology gi-

ants were machines of buy-backs. Now, the AI build-out is so large that even the richest companies are testing the limits of internal cash flow and debt markets. As bond yields rise, expensive or overvalued equity can become the cheaper currency to fund the build-outs as compared to debt where interest rates are rising. While Alphabet's offer-

USDJPY at 40-year lows



2-year yield > Fed funds rate implies rate hikes ahead



ing found strong bids, including from Berkshire Hathaway, concerns could build over a flood of supply hitting markets. Rumours of additional offerings from Big Tech come just as SpaceX is expected to launch a roughly \$75-billion IPO next week. Add to this potential mega listings from Anthropic and OpenAI, and markets may have to brace for an

unprecedented wave of equity issuance.

For example, the largest cash equity issuance before Alphabet's offering was during the US government bailout of AIG, when Treasury bought \$40 billion of newly issued preferred stock and took a 79.9 per cent stake in the company. The transaction size was unprecedented and massive but was warranted in a crisis situation. Alphabet's capital raise is more than twice as large — and more could follow. Gold's decline made its returns flat for the year against the dollar, while silver has slipped into negative territory.

Crypto did not offer an escape either. Bitcoin fell about 16 per cent for the week amid a record streak of spot bitcoin ETF outflows and a break from its dominant scarcity and institutional-demand narratives. Friday even saw bitcoin drop below \$60,000, sinking to lowest level since October 2024 taking its brutal drawdown to well over 50 per cent from all-time highs in 2024. Nor was the decline in oil a comforting signal. Prices fell on Friday, but global inventories are being rapidly drawn down as the Hormuz crisis escalates and the risk of a

price spike remains.

MIND YOUR SURROUNDINGS

Among other concerns, the Japanese yen, which had been hovering near 40-year lows, is now weakening against the dollar at a time when inflationary shocks are spreading. While there is ongoing debate over whether yen carry trades have fully unwound, the risk remains that a major intervention by Japan to support its currency — similar to that seen in August 2024 — could create fresh pressure on global markets.

Going by the signals, it appears fear can spike further as tensions escalated over the weekend in the Middle East conflict. Unless there is any progress on the US-Iran stalemate, investors need to brace for more turbulence in the week ahead. The clearest signal comes from how Nikkei 225 Futures which closed on Friday down by massive 5.6 per cent. All eyes will be on how Japan and Korea open on Monday, setting the tone for Indian markets. Investors need to heed what Henri Ducard tells Bruce Wayne in *Batman Begins* — 'always mind your surroundings'.

PM Modi chairs EAC meet to discuss impact of West Asia crisis and measures to push growth

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

A day after stronger-than-expected FY26 growth data was released, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday chaired a meeting of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) to review the impact of the West Asia crisis on the economy and discuss the way forward.

While no specific decisions were announced, sources said the meeting deliberated on reforms to improve Ease of Doing Business, boost consumption and provide relief to citizens.

"Chaired a meeting of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. Deliberated on a wide range of issues relating to India's economic transformation and



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, flanked by Principal Secretaries PK Mishra (left) and Shaktikanta Das, chairs a meeting of the PM-Economic Advisory Council, in New Delhi on Saturday **PMO**

long-term development priorities. Also shared perspectives on adding more momentum to the reforms journey and ensuring 'Ease of Living' as well as 'Ease of Doing Business'," Modi said in a social media post.

The meeting was attended by the Prime Minister's Principal Secretaries, PK Mishra and Shaktikanta Das.

The EAC-PM is an independent body that advises the Prime Minister on eco-

nomics and related issues. It comprises a Chairman, three full-time members and 11 part-time members.

S Mahendra Dev is the Chairman, while Sanjay Kumar Mishra, Sanjeev Sanyal and Shamika Ravi serve as full-time members.

SUSTAINING MOMENTUM

According to sources, EAC-PM members presented their assessment of the impact of

the West Asia conflict on India and the global economy. The Prime Minister and members discussed measures to sustain India's growth momentum amid global uncertainty. Reforms aimed at improving Ease of Living and Ease of Doing Business also figured prominently in the discussions.

ROBUST Q4, FY26

The meeting comes against the backdrop of robust FY26

growth numbers released on Friday. India's real GDP grew 7.8 per cent in Q4, taking full-year growth to 7.7 per cent. Real GDP at constant prices was estimated at ₹87.77 lakh crore in Q4 compared with ₹81.40 lakh crore a year earlier, while nominal GDP rose 9.1 per cent to ₹94.65 lakh crore.

Gross Value Added (GVA), a key measure of economic activity, is estimated to have grown 7.9 per cent in FY26, while nominal GVA increased 9.1 per cent. In Q4 FY26, real GVA expanded 7.9 per cent and nominal GVA 9.9 per cent.

The secondary and tertiary sectors remained the primary drivers of growth, expanding 8.8 per cent and 9.3 per cent, respectively, during FY26. The primary sector grew 3.2 per cent, supported largely by agriculture and fisheries.

Govt standardises edible oil pack sizes for easy price comparison

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Department of Consumer Affairs has prescribed standard pack sizes for edible oils under the Legal Metrology framework to help consumers compare prices across brands and make informed purchasing decisions.

In a statement on Saturday, the Department said it has amended the Standard Operating Procedure (SoP) governing net quantity declarations and standard pack sizes for edible oils and fats. Manufacturers, packers and importers have three months to comply with the new norms.

The move follows consultations with industry associations representing nearly 90 per cent of the edible oil sector. According to the Department, the proliferation of

non-standard pack sizes in recent years has made price comparison difficult and created confusion among consumers.

The revised SoP prescribes nine standard pack sizes — 200 ml/g, 500 ml/g, 1 litre/kg, 2 litre/kg, 3 litre/kg, 4 litre/kg, 5 litre/kg, 15 litre/kg and 20 litre/kg — for major edible oils, including palm, soybean, sunflower, mustard, groundnut, sesame, rice bran, cottonseed and corn oil, as well as blended oils.

VOLUME DECLARATION

The new rules also mandate declaration of both volume and equivalent weight on packs to improve transparency. The provisions apply to both domestically manufactured and imported edible oils. Packages below 200 ml or 200 grams and minor edible oils have been exempted from

the standard pack-size requirement to ensure the continued availability of affordable small packs. Companies may adopt the new pack sizes immediately, even before the transition period ends.

Welcoming the move, Sudhakar Desai, President of the Indian Vegetable Oil Producers' Association, said it would "restore structural sanity to retail shelves and level the playing field". He noted that while flexibility in pack sizes was intended to give industry greater freedom, it had led to a proliferation of non-standard packs and widespread market confusion.

The Department said the initiative would also benefit the industry by bringing greater uniformity in packaging practices, easing compliance, encouraging fair competition and improving market transparency.

AI will reshape jobs, but India's big challenge is preparing workers, boards and classrooms

Jyoti Banthia
Siddhi Patil
Bengaluru

The debate around Artificial Intelligence has largely been framed around a single question: Will it take away jobs?

But at *The Hindu* Huddle's session on "I, Robot: How AI is reshaping the future of work", industry veterans argued that India risks missing a far more important conversation — how to redesign education, skilling, research and businesses for an AI-led future.

The panel, moderated by *businessline* editor Raghuvir Srinivasan, brought together former Cognizant CEO Lakshmi Narayanan, former Nasscom president and NITI Aayog distinguished fellow Debjani Ghosh, and B Santhanam, former CEO-Asia Pacific and India Region & Chairman, Saint-Gobain India.

For Ghosh, the current

narrative around AI-driven job losses is often misplaced.

ONLY A CORRECTION

"A lot of the displacements till now were due to over-hiring during the pandemic. So it was correction that was happening," she said, pushing back against the view that AI is already eliminating large numbers of jobs.

That does not mean the risks are insignificant. As AI systems become capable of performing routine and repetitive tasks, entry-level jobs are likely to come under the greatest pressure.

"The entry-level will definitely get disrupted. And that is important because that's millions of people in India and millions of youngsters in India," Ghosh said.

The challenge, she argued, is not to resist AI but to redesign work around it. Rather than viewing jobs as fixed roles, employers and policymakers need to break them down into tasks and identify

which parts can be automated and which continue to require human judgement.

That future, she said, will be defined by what she called the "human sandwich model".

"You need the humans to frame the questions and inputs, AI does the work, and then you need humans again at the end to verify the outcome," she said, adding that the model will become even more critical as autonomous AI agents become commonplace.

The conversation soon moved beyond jobs to India's place in the global AI economy.

While India has emerged as one of the world's largest digital markets, Ghosh warned that being a consumer of technology is not the same as creating value from it.

"If you look at the \$17.6 trillion prediction of how much value AI will create in the next five years, 80 per cent of that is going to two



Debjani Ghosh, former President of Nasscom and Distinguished Fellow at NITI Aayog; Lakshmi Narayanan, former CEO, Cognizant and Chancellor, Krea University; B Santhanam, former CEO - Asia Pacific and India Region & Chairman, Saint-Gobain India; in conversation with Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, *businessline*, at the sixth edition of The Hindu Huddle in Bengaluru on Saturday **MURALI KUMAR K**

countries, the US and China. For India, we should at least aspire to get 10 per cent of that," she said.

3 FOCUS SECTORS

Santhanam, however, believes India's biggest opportunity may not lie in competing head-on with Silicon Valley's frontier models. In-

stead, he argued that the country can create disproportionate impact through the diffusion of AI across sectors such as agriculture, education and healthcare.

"The most important work is in diffusion at these three areas — agriculture, education and health. That's where I think AI can do what hu-

mans cannot do," he said.

He pointed to examples where AI-powered solutions developed for Indian agricultural ecosystems were adapted for use elsewhere within months, highlighting the country's ability to deploy technology at scale.

Yet Santhanam reserved his sharpest criticism for cor-

porate India. "In the Nifty 45, there are 230 independent directors. Less than 10 per cent of them have any understanding or knowledge of technology. That's the state of our boards," he said.

The lack of engagement with AI at the board level, he argued, is particularly concerning at a time when the technology is rapidly transforming industries. "Not one company in the managing director's report had AI mentioned. Not one. That's shocking."

WEAK LINKS

Lakshmi Narayanan echoed concerns about India's preparedness, particularly in education and research. Asked whether Indian colleges are producing graduates ready for the AI era, his answer was blunt. "The short answer is no."

India has historically excelled at adopting and scaling technologies, he said, but has under-invested in the inven-

tion and research that drive technological leadership.

"We are not investing enough in research. The blame goes to the private sector," he said.

The former Cognizant chief argued that while India is comfortable with diffusion, it needs far stronger capabilities in innovation and research if it hopes to play a meaningful role in shaping the next wave of AI.

Taken together, the panelists painted a picture that was neither utopian nor alarmist. AI will disrupt jobs, particularly at the bottom of the pyramid. It will create new opportunities as well. But whether India emerges as a creator of value or merely a consumer of it will depend on how quickly it can overhaul its classrooms, boardrooms and workforce for a technology that is moving faster than any before it.

Siddhi Patil is an intern with *businessline*

bl.portfolio

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

The National Pension System (NPS) is a defined-contribution retirement savings scheme. Introduced initially for new Central government employees in 2004, it was extended to all citizens in 2009. NPS has evolved into a low-cost, market-linked investment platform that combines elements of mutual funds, provident funds and traditional pension products.

The regulator, the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA), has steadily refined the product to transform from a basic pension accumulation vehicle into a comprehensive retirement solution.

Recent initiatives such as NPS Vatsalya for minors, Multi Scheme Framework (MSF) that allows subscribers to maintain multiple investment baskets, and the Retirement Income Scheme (RIS), which enables phased withdrawals after retirement, reflect this evolving approach.

For investors beginning their retirement journey, understanding how NPS works, how it invests, the returns it has generated and the choices available at retirement is essential before deciding whether it deserves a place in their portfolio.

Here we focus more on the non-government subscribers including All Citizen and corporate models.

NPS STRUCTURE

Individuals aged between 18 and 85 can join the NPS system. Broadly, the NPS journey has two stages: The accumulation phase and the decumulation (withdrawal) phase.

During the accumulation phase, subscribers make periodic contributions through their working years, either monthly, quarterly, half-yearly or annually. These contributions are invested in market-linked instruments, enabling the retirement corpus to grow over time.

The decumulation phase begins when a subscriber reaches retirement age or the vesting date. A portion of the accumulated corpus must be used to purchase an annuity that provides a regular pension. Subscribers may also defer lump-sum withdrawals and annuity purchase until the age of 85, as per latest norms. An NPS account remains active until the subscriber attains 85 years of age, after which it is closed.

HOW DOES NPS INVEST

NPS contributions are invested through professional pension fund managers, with subscribers having the flexibility to choose and change both the fund manager and the asset allocation. The pension fund management industry currently comprises 10 players: SBI Pension, UTI Pension, LIC Pension, HDFC Pension, ICICI Prudential Pension, Kotak Pension, Aditya Birla SL Pension, Axis Pension, Tata Pension and Max Life Pension Fund.

Every subscriber is required to open a Tier-I account, which serves as the primary retirement account and offers tax benefits. Withdrawals from this account are restricted. Subscribers may also open a Tier-II account, which functions as a voluntary savings account with greater liquidity but limited tax advantages.

Investments are allocated across asset classes that are now classified as common schemes such as equity (E), corporate debt (C) and government securities (G). Alternate Assets (A) was



Your all-round guide to NPS

PENSION PLANNING. We unpack everything first-time investors need to know about NPS, from contributions to retirement income

GETTY IMAGES

discontinued effective December 25, 2025. Pension managers offer these asset classes separately in both Tier-I and Tier-II accounts.

Subscribers under All Citizen model can choose between two investment approaches. Under Active Choice, you can plan and choose on how your contribution is to be invested among the three funds. You can choose the pension manager, the schemes as well as the percentage allocation in the asset classes. However, allocation to E is capped at 75 per cent, while you can allocate up to 100 per cent into C and G. This option suits those who are comfortable managing their own asset allocation.

Auto Choice in NPS is a lifecycle-based investment option where asset allocation is automatically adjusted based on age. Equity exposure is higher when the investor is young and gradually reduces as retirement approaches. Within Auto Choice, investors under All Citizen Model can select from four lifecycle variants based on risk appetite. These include Life Cycle 75 (High), Life Cycle 50 (Moderate), Life Cycle 25 (Low) and Life Cycle Aggressive. These funds follow a predefined glide path, automatically rebalancing equity and debt over time, making Auto Choice suitable for investors seeking a hands-off, disciplined approach to retirement investing.

NPS ACCOUNT OPENING

An NPS account can be opened online through the eNPS portals operated by Protean, KFinTech and CAMS, as well as through banks and fintech platforms that act as Points of Presence (PoPs).

Subscribers can open an account using Aadhaar, PAN or DigiLocker authentication. Aadhaar-based digital onboarding has made account opening largely paperless and can often be completed within minutes.

Alternatively, one can opt for the offline route through banks and authorised PoPs, where forms are submitted and verification is done physically. Link for registration portals: <https://shorturl.at/YEOwF>. Minimum contribution is ₹250 at the time of onboarding. If you don't contribute at least ₹1,000 a financial

year to your NPS Tier-I account, it can become inactive.

Subscribers can track their NPS investments by logging into the CRA portal or mobile app for real-time account details, and they also receive annual transaction statements and SMS/email updates.

Before opening the account, investors should decide on three key aspects: The pension fund manager, the investment option (Active Choice or Auto Choice) and nominee details. These can be changed later, but having clarity upfront makes the process smoother.

WITHDRAWAL

The PFRDA 2025 framework for non-government subscribers, including All Citizen Model, marks a clear shift toward flexibility while retaining the core retirement discipline of NPS. A subscriber can opt for a normal exit after attaining 60 years, superannuation, or completing at least 15 years of subscription, effectively introducing a vesting-based exit alongside age-based exit. At this stage, only 20 per cent of the accumulated pension wealth is mandatorily annuitised, with the balance 80 per cent available as lump-sum or structured withdrawals, offering significantly higher liquidity.

However, for Central government employees, normal exit is linked to retirement from service or attaining the age of 60, wherein the 40 per cent of the accumulated pension wealth is mandatorily annuitised.

Subscribers can defer both withdrawal and annuity purchase until age 85, without making fresh contributions, allowing the remaining corpus to continue participating in market-linked growth.

Premature (voluntary) exit in NPS is allowed before meeting normal exit conditions, but with restrictions. At least 80 per cent of the corpus must be annuitised, with only 20 per cent allowed as lump-sum, ensuring retirement income discipline.

Full withdrawal is permitted for small balances of ₹5 lakh or less. On death, the

WISE WORDS.

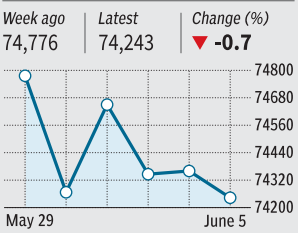


Investors judge the market price by established standards of value, while speculators base [their] standards of value upon the market price

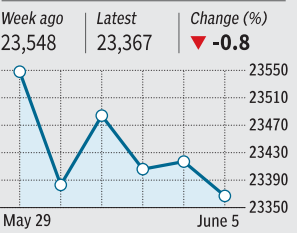
BENJAMIN GRAHAM
'Father of value investing'

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



Performance and portfolio composition of fund options

Under the NPS All Citizen Model, subscribers can invest in three asset classes through both Tier-I and Tier-II accounts: E, C and G.

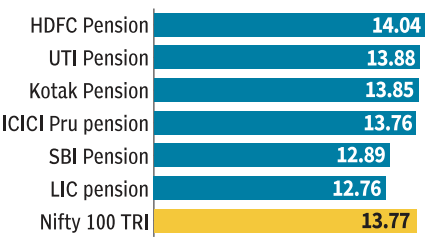
NPS earlier offered 'A', which invested in instruments such as Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs), Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) and AT1 bonds. However, it was discontinued in December 2025 due to its limited investment universe and scalability challenges. To ensure continuity, the regulator integrated these exposures into E and C to invest up to 5 per cent of their corpus in such instruments. Over the years, NPS has broadened its investment universe while retaining a conservative retirement-focused framework.

Equity (E)

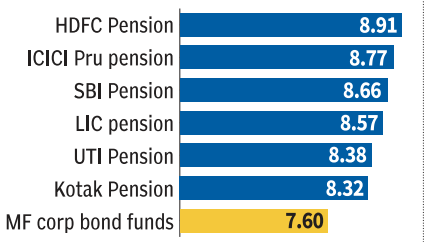
Fund E began as a passive strategy and then evolved into an actively-managed fund. Under current regulations, pension

How NPS Tier-I funds fared in rolling return basis

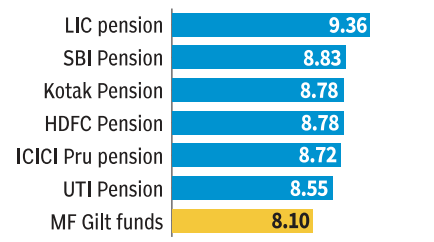
Tier-I: Fund - E (Equity)



Tier-I: Fund - C (Corporate Bonds)



Tier-I: Fund - G (Government Securities)



Source: Respective NPS websites. Rolling return data is calculated using NAV values from July 2, 2013 onward. six having track records exceeding a decade. Category averages for direct mutual fund corporate bond funds and gilt funds categories are used. Values are as of June 1, 2026

fund managers can invest in stocks that are part of the Nifty 250 and BSE 250 universes. They can also allocate up to 5 per cent of assets collectively to REITs, InvITs, Category I and II Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), and gold & silver ETFs.

Based on 10-year rolling return analysis using the last 13 years of NAV data, Tier-I Fund E schemes delivered an average

annualised return of 13.5 per cent, marginally below the Nifty 100 TRI's 13.8 per cent.

Corporate Bonds (C)

This primarily invests in listed corporate debt issued by public sector enterprises and private companies. The permissible universe also includes REITs, InvITs, municipal bonds, rupee bonds issued by international

banks, PSU debt ETFs, AT1 bonds and debt-oriented Category I and II AIFs.

While Fund C can invest in securities rated AA and above, up to 10 per cent of assets may be allocated to bonds rated between A and AA-.

Interest-rate calls are limited, with portfolio-modified duration typically maintained between four and six years.

Government Securities (G)

Fund G invests primarily in Central and State government securities. Fund managers have flexibility to choose maturities ranging from one year to 50 years. Portfolio-modified duration generally ranges between eight and 12 years.

Both debt-oriented NPS funds have outperformed comparable mutual fund categories

over the long term. Ten-year rolling return analysis shows that Tier-I Fund C generated an average annualised return of 8.6 per cent, comfortably ahead of the 7.6 per cent delivered by corporate bond mutual funds (direct plans). Similarly, Fund G posted an average return of 8.8 per cent, exceeding the 8.1 per cent return from direct gilt mutual funds.

Asset allocation remains one of the most important decisions for NPS subscribers. Younger investors with long investment horizons can benefit from a higher allocation to Fund E up to 75 per cent under active choice, while those nearing retirement may prefer a greater allocation to Fund C and Fund G to reduce volatility and protect accumulated savings. For investors who do not wish to manage allocations actively, NPS also offers Auto Choice life-cycle funds, where equity exposure automatically declines with age.

two methods. One is Systematic Payout Rate (SPR). Here, the annual withdrawal rate depends on your age. At 60, the payout rate works out to about 4 per cent that increase as you age. The second method is Systematic Unit Redemption (SUR) like the SWP (Systematic Withdrawal Plan) of mutual funds.

LOWER COST

NPS is among the cheapest investment products available to Indian investors. Opening an NPS account typically costs around ₹200, while annual record-keeping and administrative charges are generally about ₹400. Accounts opened through banks and other PoPs may also attract a servicing fee of up to 0.20 per cent of AUM. Direct eNPS accounts, by contrast, tend to be the lowest-cost option.

The investment management fee (IMF) under NPS has long been among the lowest in the Indian investment landscape. Under the revised fee structure effective April 2026, pension funds can charge non-government sector subscribers up to 0.12 per cent on assets up to ₹25,000 crore, with the rate declining up to 0.04 per cent as AUM rises through higher slabs. Even after accounting for administrative and record-keeping expenses, the overall cost of investing through NPS works out to roughly 0.3 per cent of AUM.

This compares favourably with the average expense ratios of equity MFs, which are around 1.3 per cent for regular plans and 0.73 per cent for direct plans. Debt funds, meanwhile, charge about 1.1 per cent and 0.6 per cent respectively. While the difference in costs may seem marginal in any given year, over a working life of three decades or more, lower expenses can significantly boost the final retirement corpus through the power of compounding. For instance, a ₹10-lakh investment, growing at 12 per cent annually for 25 years, becomes about ₹1.70 crore, while the same investment at 11.5 per cent (just 50 bps lower due to higher charges) grows to only ₹1.52 crore, creating a gap of nearly ₹18 lakh.

MSF AND NPS VATSALYA

Multiple Scheme Framework (MSF) gives non-government subscribers greater flexibility. While earlier investors were limited to predefined schemes with up to 75 per cent equity exposure, MSF allows multiple schemes within a single account and enables pension fund managers to offer 100 per cent equity strategies and funds across equity, hybrid, debt and other asset classes. NPS Vatsalya allows parents or guardians to open and manage an NPS account for minors, with contributions made on their behalf until adulthood.

The biggest trade-off with NPS is liquidity and flexibility. The product is designed to keep investors locked into a retirement-focused structure, limiting access to money before retirement. At exit, a mandatory portion of the corpus must be used to purchase an annuity, locking retirees into products that typically offer modest returns and taxable income.

Tax advantage

For non-government NPS subscribers, the tax treatment under the Income-Tax Act, 2025, broadly continues the EET (Exempt-Exempt-Taxable) framework, with certain rationalisation and renumbering of provisions explains, Sanjiv Chaudhary, Chartered Accountant.

According to Chaudhary, the NPS deduction of ₹50,000 under Section 124 of Income Tax Act 2025 (New Act) is in addition to the overall ceiling of ₹1.5 lakh.

* **Individual's contribution** qualifies for tax deduction up to 10 per cent of salary (Basic + DA).

* **Employer's contribution** qualifies for tax deduction in the hands of employee up to 10 per cent of salary (Basic + DA) under the old taxation regime and up to 14 per cent of salary (Basic + DA) under the new taxation regime.

Individuals who are self-employed and contributing to NPS are eligible for tax deduction up to 20 per cent of gross income within the overall ceiling of ₹1.5 lakh and additional deduction up to ₹50,000 he adds.

Partial withdrawals are permitted under PFRDA regulations for specified purposes, out of which only up to 25 per cent of the subscriber's self-contributions are exempt from tax. At retirement or normal exit, PFRDA permits non-government subscribers to withdraw up to 80 per cent of the accumulated corpus as lump-sum, the Income-Tax rules exempt only up to 60 per cent and 20 per cent of corpus is taxable as per applicable slab rate. The exempt portion of the lump-sum withdrawal continues to be exempt under the NPS provisions.

The 20 per cent corpus used for annuitisation is not taxable at the time of purchase of the annuity. However, the annuity/pension received thereafter is fully taxable in the year of receipt under the head "Income from Other Sources", says Chaudhary.

bl.explainer

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

The rupee recovered by 0.9 per cent on Friday, after supportive measures from the government and the RBI. While the government passed an ordinance exempting FIIs from tax on income from government securities (G-Secs), the RBI announced a suite of measures to alleviate India’s balance of payments (BoP) challenge. The key among them involves an FCNR swap window, mirroring a similar measure in 2013, when Raghuram Rajan was the then Governor. Rajan would then go on to admit in a 2016 event on how he initially viewed the idea as ‘idiotic’ and changed his stance, subsequently realising its benefits. What is the FCNR swap window? Will the magic work this time too? Here’s an explainer.

What is the RBI’s measure involving FCNR (B) deposits to garner forex inflows?
FCNR (B) deposits or Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits are term deposits that NRIs (non-resident Indians), OCIs (overseas citizens of India) and PIOs (persons of Indian origin) can open with Indian commercial banks, like SBI. Under these accounts, both the deposit of principal and redemption happen in foreign currency — thus, the depositor is safeguarded against depreciation of the rupee. On top of this, the interest on these accounts is exempt from tax in India.

That said, the central bank has now announced a facility where it will bear the hedging cost with respect to FCNR (B) deposits raised by AD (authorised dealer) banks up to September 30, on behalf of such banks. An important condition is that the tenor on these deposits must be three-five years. AD banks are, basically, Indian commercial banks that are licensed by the RBI to deal in foreign exchange. The list includes major public and private sector banks.

How does the facility work?
Since Indian banks lend in rupees,



POLICY MOVES. With rupee facing external pressure, here’s a lowdown on the RBI’s recent FCNR (B) swap window measure

they have no use having the FCNR deposits in foreign currency, unless they can find lending opportunities in those currencies. Hence, once raised, they convert them to rupees. Since upon maturity, deposits are to be redeemed in foreign currency, banks must convert rupees back to foreign currency. In the inter-mittent period, they are exposed to fluctuations in the currency market. To hedge themselves from this currency risk, banks generally enter into swap contracts (co-terminus with the maturity of these deposits) to lock-in a forward exchange rate, as immediately as raising those deposits. Come redemption, this forward rate is the rate at which banks would convert rupees back to foreign currency, to repay the depositor.

While doing so, banks incur a hedging cost. This will be on top of the interest rate banks promise to pay the depositor. Such hedging

cost is exactly what the RBI is offering to bear on behalf of AD banks. Per Anshul Chandak, Head of Treasury at RBL Bank, this is expected to cost the central bank 3.5-3.75 per cent per annum on every billion-dollar raised via the FCNR (B) route — roughly translating to \$34 million or ₹325 crore per billion dollars (at today’s exchange rate).

Had it not been for this facility, SBI, for instance, would have roughly incurred 7.1 per cent per annum on a three-year USD FCNR (B) deposit — interest rate of 3.6 per cent plus hedge cost of 3.5 per cent. Now that it can avail RBI’s facility, its cost would be reduced to just the interest rate of 3.6 per cent on the deposit.

What are the historical precedents?
In 2013, during the infamous Taper Tantrum — when the then Fed Chair Ben Bernanke hinted that the US Fed would soon begin

reducing or ‘tapering’ post-2008 bond-buying or quantitative easing, rupee was under serious pressure. Rupee depreciated by a massive 29 per cent in merely a span of four months between May and August of 2013 (from ₹54 a dollar to ₹69), grouping India amongst the ‘fragile five’ economies then. India was already struggling from two years of sharp current account deficits of 4.3 per cent and 4.7 per cent for FY12 and FY13 respectively. Balance of payments (which includes both current and capital account) recorded a deficit of 0.7 per cent of GDP in FY12 and marginally broke even at 0.2 per cent of GDP in FY13. The situation called for immediate action to save the currency. When Rajan succeeded Duvvuri Subbarao as the Governor of RBI in September 2013, the central bank announced a similar swap window for FCNR (B) deposits. The RBI offered banks to swap fresh FCNR (B)

dollar funds, raised for a minimum tenor of three years at a concessional fixed rate of 3.5 per cent. This was roughly half of what it would have costed banks to hedge the risk at that time — 7 per cent vs 3.5-3.75 per cent now.

Did the 2013 swap window work?
It did! Reportedly, banks mobilised about \$30 billion of much-needed forex when the window was kept open until November 30, 2013. Going by RBI’s BoP data, net non-resident deposits (FCNR (B) plus other NR deposits) recorded a sharp spike to \$39 billion in FY14, which was merely \$7.4 billion on average in the past five years (FY09-13). The rupee appreciated to ₹62 to the dollar from the bottom of ₹69 by August-end. BoP recorded a surplus of 0.8 per cent of GDP for FY14.

It is interesting to note how this window immensely benefited NRIs, who borrowed dollars at

near-zero rates in developed markets and invested in such FCNR (B) deposits, against the collateral of the very FCNR deposits themselves. Here is an excerpt from former SEBI whole-time member Ananth Narayan’s blog on how the scheme operated for some NRIs.

“Consider a Singapore-based NRI with \$100,000 to deposit. The proposal her bank would have shown her in late 2013 would have looked somewhat like this:

Start with your original \$100,000.

Borrow an additional \$900,000 from the bank in Singapore for three years, at 2 per cent per annum.

Place the entire \$1,000,000 as a three-year FCNR deposit in Mumbai at 3 per cent per annum and put this up as collateral against your \$900,000-loan.

On redemption of the FCNR deposit, pay back the \$900,000-loan, and take back your net \$100,000

principal.

Each year, you would earn an interest of \$30,000 (3 per cent on \$1,000,000).

Each year, you would pay an interest of \$18,000 (2 per cent on \$900,000).

On a net basis therefore, each year, you would earn a net interest of \$12,000 – or 12 per cent on your original \$100,000!”

Here’s an interesting tidbit. Though markets celebrated Rajan for this idea, the former Governor later admitted that it was, in fact, not his and how he was not in favour of it initially. Before his stint as Governor, he was serving as an officer on special duty, under Subbarao. Among the many ideas the central bank officials had floated to prop the rupee, Rajan found the idea about the FCNR swap window ‘completely idiotic’. His rationale being that the government would have to foot the ₹10,000-20,000 crore swap subsidy bill. With Rajan in the ‘nay’ camp, he found Subbarao, the deputy governors and even the Finance Ministry in the ‘aye’ camp.

However, he later found merit in the idea — that a stronger rupee as a result of FCNR inflows can save up to ₹1.6 trillion on India’s \$400-billion import bill. Subbarao would then go on to let Rajan announce the swap facility himself, the very day he took over as the Governor.

Will the same measure work this time around?
While the pressure on the rupee is similar to that of 2013, things are a bit different now. Primarily, while yields in the developed markets were close to zero then — conducive for non-residents to borrow and invest or even just invest their own savings, it is not so now. Yield on three-year US Treasury bonds are anyway elevated at around 4.2 per cent, while that on SBI’s FCNR (B)s is 3.6 per cent. Some banks in the US are already offering up to 4.2-4.35 per cent on USD deposits. Hence, for the window to work this time, it largely hinges on how much Indian banks can pass the benefit on to the depositors, as explained above. This is also the expectation of the central bank, as stated by Governor Mahota in the post-monetary policy press conference.

Debt funds make cautious return to credit risk

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

India’s debt mutual fund industry is showing signs of reviving its appetite for credit risk. A bl.portfolio analysis of actively-managed debt funds over the past eight years shows that exposure to lower-rated debt instruments (AA and below) declined sharply in the aftermath of a series of credit events, but has begun to recover over the past year.

The share of AA-and-below instruments in active debt fund assets fell from 12.4 per cent in April 2018 to 2.6 per cent by April 2023. It briefly recovered in 2024, slipped further to 2.3 per cent in April 2025, and then rose to 3.1 per cent in April 2026. In absolute terms, exposure dropped from more than ₹1.2 lakh crore in 2018 to about ₹30,000 crore at its trough in April 2023, before rebounding to ₹55,059 crore by April 2026.

For this study, debt index funds, debt ETFs, overnight funds and gilt funds were excluded. The analysis is restricted to 13 actively-managed debt fund categories that have the flexibility to invest in lower-rated debt securities. These are credit risk, medium duration, low duration, dynamic bond, short duration, ultra short duration, banking & PSU, medium to long duration, floating rate, corporate bond, money market, long duration and liquid funds.

CREDIT EVENTS HIT
The retreat from lower-rated bonds is rooted in a series of credit events that exposed the fragility of high-yield investing. During 2017-20, many fund houses followed a yield-chasing model that relied on lower-rated issuers rather than prioritising liquidity. Many debt fund schemes, including those in the short-duration and ultra-short-duration categories, held sizeable exposure to bonds rated AA and below.

A series of bond downgrades and defaults hit debt funds hard. The collapse of IL&FS in 2018 triggered widespread markdowns across debt schemes. This was followed by defaults and downgrades involving DHFL, Reliance Group entities, Essel Group companies and several NBFCs. The final blow came in 2020 when Franklin Templeton MF wound up six debt schemes with assets



RISK CONTROL
Corporate bond funds and banking & PSU funds offer relative safety through high-quality debt exposure

exceeding ₹25,000 crore due to severe liquidity pressures.

DE-RISKING
These events shattered the perception that debt funds were low-risk alternatives to fixed deposits. Investors began avoiding debt funds with sizeable allocations to lower-rated papers and shifted towards categories with higher-quality portfolios, forcing fund managers to reduce exposure to lower-rated credits.

Credit risk funds, which are mandated to maintain significant exposure to lower-rated securities, were among the hardest hit. The category’s AUM plunged from ₹73,417 crore in 2018 to ₹21,098 crore in 2026, a decline of nearly 71 per cent. Although these funds continue to maintain the highest allocation to AA-and-below papers, their influence on the overall debt fund market has

diminished sharply. Credit risk funds and medium-duration funds saw the sharpest erosion in AUM among credit-heavy categories. Other categories such as low duration and dynamic bond did not see similar AUM erosion, but they still cut exposure to AA-and-below papers sharply over the period

HIGH-QUALITY DEBT
Investors increasingly favoured safety, liquidity and predictability over incremental yield. Categories associated with higher-quality portfolios, such as corporate bond funds, banking & PSU funds and money market funds, emerged as the biggest beneficiaries. Their AUM grew 207 per cent, 155 per cent and 359 per cent, respectively, over the past eight years. Fund managers also changed their approach. For schemes that had relied on lower-rated bonds to generate incremental returns, liquidity and portfolio quality became the primary focus. Even categories such as medium-duration, dynamic bond and short-duration funds sharply reduced exposure to lower-rated issuers. The average allocation to AA-and-below

papers in medium-duration funds fell from 35 per cent in April 2018 to 27 per cent in April 2026. Low-duration funds reduced such exposure from 12 per cent to 5 per cent, while dynamic bond and short-duration funds cut it from 8 per cent to 4 per cent.

Credit risk funds also saw their reported allocation to AA-and-below papers fall to about 55 per cent over the past eight years. This should be read with some caution. Portfolio-disclosure numbers are calculated on total scheme assets, while regulatory allocation requirements and liquidity buffers may use different bases. Post-2020 liquidity-risk rules also pushed debt schemes to maintain a minimum liquidity cushion, making reported AA-and-below exposure lower than earlier periods.

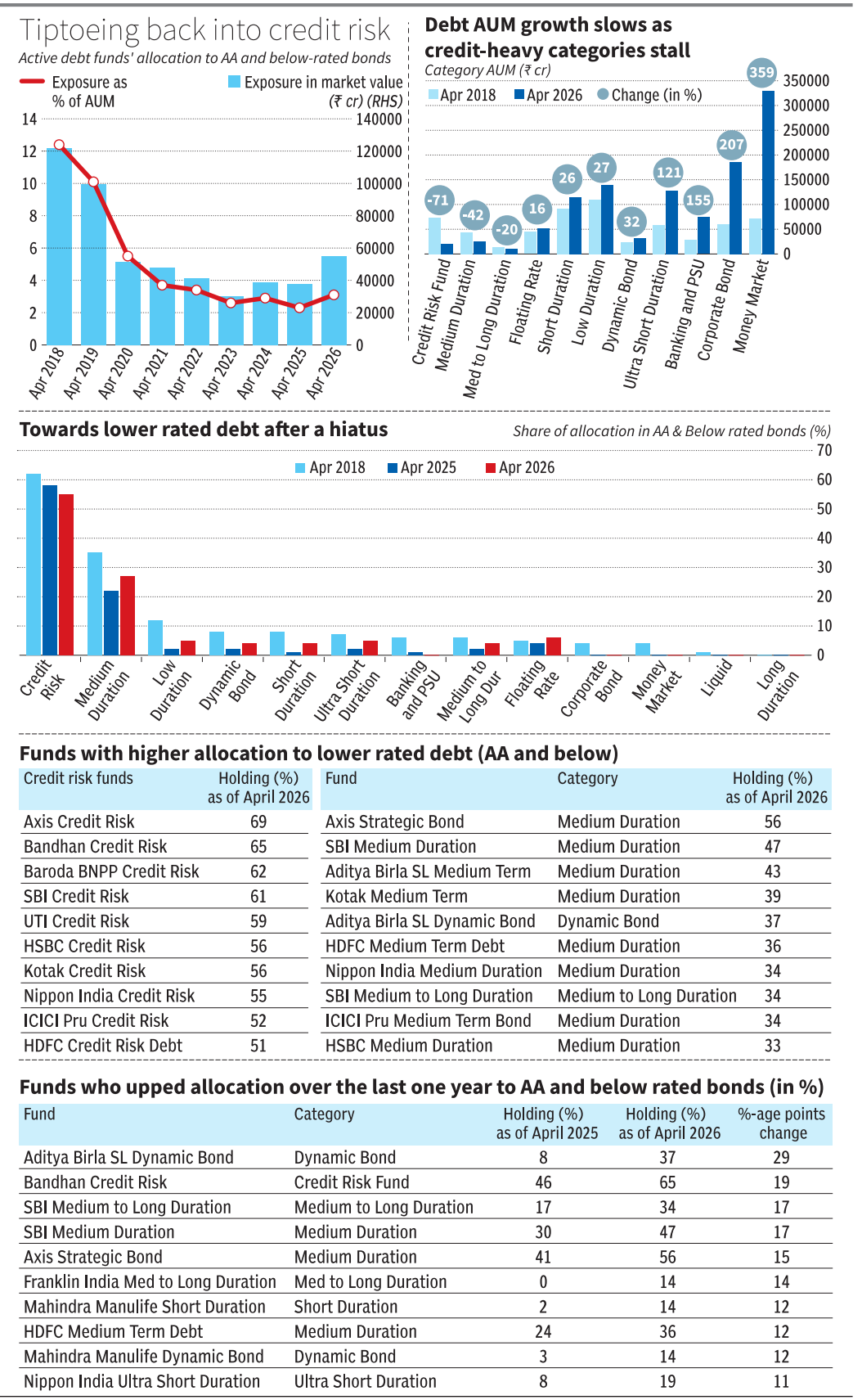
INCREASE IN AA- & BELOW
Yet the latest data hint at a notable shift. After reaching a low of 2.3 per cent of assets in 2025, lower-rated exposure increased to 3.1 per cent in 2026. In value terms, exposure rose from ₹37,610 crore to ₹55,059 crore.

Several medium-duration, dynamic bond and credit risk schemes raised allocations to AA-and-below securities. At the fund level, the shift is even more pronounced. Schemes that significantly increased exposure include Aditya Birla Sun Life Dynamic Bond Fund, SBI Medium to Long Duration Fund and SBI Medium Duration Fund (see tables).

This revival looks more like a calibrated shift than a return to aggressive risk-taking. The rise is visible in select schemes rather than across the entire debt fund universe. Fund managers appear to be adding credit exposure selectively for incremental yield, even as overall exposure to AA-and-below papers remains far below the levels seen before the credit events of 2018-20.

INVESTOR LESSONS
The era of aggressive yield-chasing through lower-rated bonds is unlikely to return anytime soon, with fund managers now prioritising capital protection. While credit risk is making a comeback as a source of alpha, it comes with higher volatility, making it crucial for investors to assess portfolio quality rather than focusing solely on returns.

Category selection remains critical. Corporate bond funds



and banking & PSU funds offer relative safety, while credit-oriented funds demand a higher risk appetite and greater patience. The lessons from past credit events remain fresh, and both fund managers and investors appear determined not to repeat earlier mistakes.

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Sector investing can look enticing, but it is also easy to get it wrong. Investors often enter a sector/theme after it has already run up, and lose patience when the cycle turns.

ICICI Prudential Multi Sector Passive FoF (formerly known as ICICI Prudential Passive Strategy Fund) tries to solve this problem differently. It uses a fund-of-funds (FoF) structure to invest across passive domestic sector equity-oriented Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs). It changes allocations based on market cycles, valuations and macro signals. Historically, it has bought ETFs across different AMCs.

Though launched in December 2003, the scheme following SEBI’s implementation of MF categorisation and rationalisation in 2018 aligned under the “Fund of Funds (FoF) - Domestic” category and started investing in ETFs. In November 2025, following SEBI’s new rules for certain FoFs, the AMC-recategorised ICICI Pru Multi Sector Passive FoF into the ‘Equity Oriented FoF (Domestic) – Sectoral/Thematic FoF – Multi-Sector’ space and got its current name.

Over the years, the fund has delivered decent performance. Sector weights are decided through a structured, forward-looking process. The idea is to reduce the influence of emotion, recency bias and short-term market swings.

For investors who want sector exposure but do not want to chase headlines, this fund can work as a disciplined satellite allocation. The key is to treat it as long-term sector-rotation product, not as a replacement for a diversified equity fund.

STRATEGY

ICICI Pru Multi Sector Passive FoF’s exposure to different sector ETFs is not fixed. It shifts exposure across sector ETFs depending on the economic backdrop and market signals. Growth, rates, inflation, earnings trends and valuations are tracked to assess whether the market is moving through recovery, expansion, late-cycle conditions or slowdown.

It aims to be dynamic across cycles. This would mean it can

A different way to ride sectors

FUND CALL. ICICI Pru Multi Sector Passive FoF changes allocations based on market cycles, valuations and macro signals

WHY INVEST

- Sector exposure without single-sector timing pressure
- Valuation filter reduces chasing recent winners
- Tested record across multiple market phases

add cyclical drivers during early recovery and expansion (for example, Power), increase defensives during uncertainty or slowdown (IT, Pharma), trim overheated sectors where valuations exceed fundamentals.

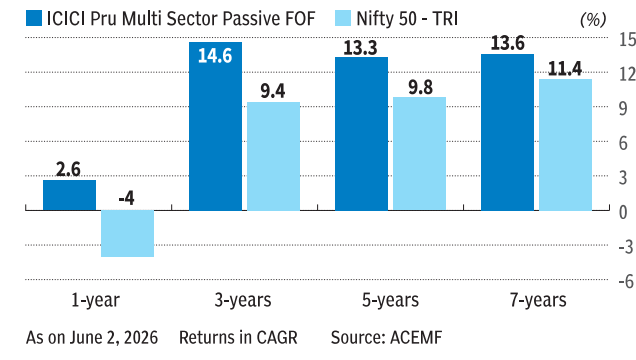
Valuation is an important part of the fund’s allocation approach. The scheme looks for sectors where the potential upside appears attractive compared with the risks, rather than relying only on recent sector performance. It can also invest across sectors and market-cap segments.

PORTFOLIO

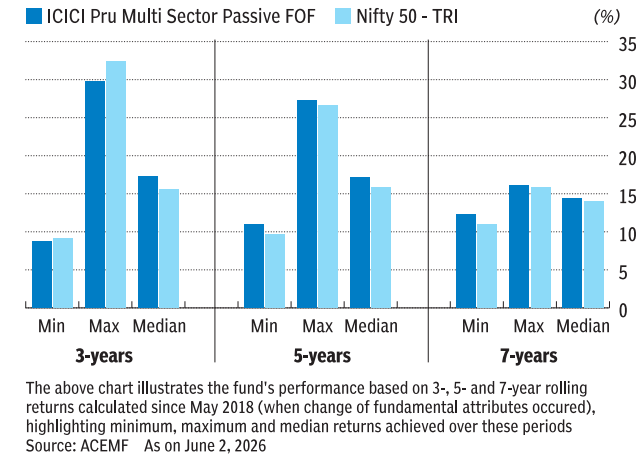
As per its April 2026 portfolio, there seems to be a decisive tilt toward private banks, maintaining it as top allocation via the ICICI Pru Nifty Private Bank ETF. The fund appears to be strategically balancing this with defensive exposures across FMCG (10.6 per cent) and Pharma (9.6 per cent). Other tactical sector allocations include Oil and Gas, IT and Power.

Let us take a look some of the fund’s actions relative to overall sentiment in the recent months. The fund reduced its metals exposure from 9.8 per cent to 6.6 per cent between December 2025 and April 2026. In case of

Trailing returns performance



Rolling returns performance



power, the fund increased its exposure from nil in October 2025 to 8.4 per cent in April 2026. Between November 2025 and April 2026, the fund reduced its broader Nifty Bank exposure from 14.8 per cent to below 6 per cent level, while simultaneously increasing its allocation to private banks from 19.2 per cent to 26.7 per cent. In case of pharma, the fund has built a substantial position, raising its ex-

posure from nil in October 2025 to around 10 per cent in April 2026. In case of IT, from a high of 13.8 per cent in November 2025, the fund has cut exposure to 8.6 per cent in April 2026.

Shedding fragmented thematic clutter like the consumption and infrastructure ETFs, the fund appears to have transitioned into a leaner, high-conviction sectoral framework over the last 12 months.

PERFORMANCE

The scheme demonstrates consistent alpha generation over Nifty 50 - TRI, across all key trailing horizons. Over a volatile one-year period, the fund delivered a positive return of 2.6 per cent against the benchmark’s -4 per cent decline, highlighting downside cushion. This outperformance widens significantly over medium-to-long horizons, with the fund outpacing the index by 520 bps, 350 bps and 220 bps over the 3-year, 5-year and 7-year periods, respectively.

Its outperformance is further seen by looking at rolling returns data calculated since the May 2018 recategorisation exercise. The fund’s three-year and five-year rolling median returns stand robust at 17.3 per cent and 17.2 per cent, comfortably beating Nifty 50 TRI. Even on a long-term seven-year rolling basis, the fund holds a superior median of 14.4 per cent while maintaining higher minimum return thresholds.

The fund’s risk ratios over the 2023-26 reveal high-quality risk-adjusted performance profile. It achieved decent outperformance while maintaining a low beta of 0.85 relative to the benchmark. A high R-squared of 0.95 confirms that a majority of its returns are explained by systematic market factors. Risk-adjusted return metrics are strong, led by a Sharpe ratio of 0.29 and a Sortino ratio of 0.53, indicating good downside risk management. The fund captured an impressive 91.1 per cent of market gains during upswings, while restricting its participation to just 75.6 per cent during downturns.

TAKEAWAYS

In the sector rotation niche, ICICI Prudential Multi Sector Passive FoF has one clear edge: track record. JioBlackRock (launched 2026) and Shriram’s (launched 2024) sector-rotation offerings are still new, while ICICI Pru’s record is tested across cycles.

Costs need watching. The FoF expense ratio is 0.4 per cent for regular and 0.2 per cent for direct plans, and underlying ETF costs make it layered. Still, NAV returns are after costs, and performance has remained decent so far.

Note that sector timing risk will not vanish. The fund’s calls can be early, late or wrong, and there will be phases when a plain Nifty 50 or flexi-cap fund does better. Still, this is safer than picking individual sector stocks. Use SIPs, keep a five-seven year horizon.

ALERTS.

Motilal Oswal MF announces BSE Clean Environment Index Fund



Motilal Oswal Mutual Fund has announced its new fund offer (NFO), “Motilal Oswal BSE Clean Environment Index Fund”, an open-ended fund replicating/tracking BSE Clean Environment Index. The NFO closes on June 19. The fund provides investors with a single, passive vehicle to participate in five transformative themes: Renewables, Electric Vehicles, Water Treatment, Recycling and Waste Management. Minimum application will be ₹500 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The fund will charge a 1 per cent exit load if investments are redeemed on or before 15 days from date of allotment.

Restrictions on lumpsum subscriptions in Gold ETF and Gold ETF FoF by HDFC AMC



In light of the broader economic and market conditions, HDFC Mutual Fund has informed that it has been decided to temporarily restrict lump-sum subscriptions in HDFC Gold ETF and HDFC Gold ETF Fund of Fund (FoF) until further notice in the following manner. For HDFC Gold ETF, subscription transactions by large investors directly with HDFC Mutual Fund (investing minimum ₹25 crore) shall not be accepted, effective June 8. For HDFC Gold ETF FoF, lump-sum purchases/switch-ins into the FoF shall be processed only up to a limit of ₹10 lakh per PAN per calendar month (at first holder level). This limit shall apply in respect of transactions received after cut-off time (3 pm) on June 5.

ETF movers

ETF	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on June 5			
Mirae NYSE FANG+ ETF	159	207	4	1,150
Motilal Nasdaq Q50 ETF	116	147	4	106
Mirae Hangseng Tech ETF	20	25	2	2,468
Groww BSE Hospitals ETF	51	51	2	892
Motilal Nasdaq 100 ETF	268	343	2	2,946
ICICI Nifty PSU Bank ETF	84	84	2	1,041
HDFC Nifty PSU Bank ETF	84	84	2	123
GOLD ETFs				
Union Gold ETF	150	152	0	9
Baroda BNPP Gold ETF	148	150	-1	421
LIC MF Gold ETF	138	139	-1	612

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on June 5, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR					
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on June 5	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
ICICI Pru Pension	72	13	12	13	28,177
Kotak Pension	65	12	12	13	4,533
UTI Pension	69	12	11	13	5,280
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
ABSL Pension	19	6	6	-	2,953
UTI Pension	37	6	6	7	4,079
LIC Pension	31	6	6	8	8,645
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension	30	8	7	8	33,770
ICICI Pru Pension	46	7	6	8	13,416
SBI Pension	46	7	6	8	15,231
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
ICICI Pru Pension	57	12	12	13	791
Kotak Pension	57	12	12	13	220
ABSL Pension	28	12	11	-	54

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on June 5, 2026

Top PMS schemes

AMC		Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
				1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP						
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	11.2	23.2	22.8	
ICICI Pru	Largecap	853	6.1	19.5	17.3	
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	6.6	20.4	16.2	
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-3.9	12.6	15.6	
MULTI CAP						
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	117	9.4	29.1	26.1	
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	6,992	12.3	37.6	25.1	
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	434	12.1	28.4	24.5	
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	118	17.8	30.8	24.5	
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,096	16.2	26.2	24.2	
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	6.2	21.0	24.2	
MID-CAP						
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	9.7	17.5	18.0	
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.1	24.4	17.5	
Eureka PMS	Signature Approach	NA	7.0	21.3	16.8	
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	3.6	16.0	16.5	
SMALL CAP						
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,592	40.0	42.0	41.8	
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	895	2.6	23.0	36.4	
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,278	0.8	31.8	26.3	
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	14.9	29.8	23.6	

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on April 30, 2026

Change in allocation over last 12 months (%)

Holding	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26
ICICI Pru Nifty Private Bank ETF	20.2	18.9	19.1	18.4	18.5	19.0	19.2	18.6	19.3	25.0	25.9	26.7
ICICI Pru Nifty FMCG ETF	8.6	8.2	7.7	7.8	6.6	7.5	12.3	11.9	11.9	11.8	11.6	10.6
Nippon India Nifty Pharma ETF							8.1	7.9	8.2	9.5	10.2	9.6
ICICI Pru Nifty Oil & Gas ETF	7.7	7.6	7.9	7.7	7.9	8.1	8.1	8.0	8.2	8.7	8.4	9.4
ICICI Pru Nifty IT ETF	8.2	10.0	10.2	10.7	10.7	11.0	13.8	11.8	11.3	9.0	9.4	8.6
Groww BSE Power ETF							1.0	4.3	5.5	7.4	8.2	8.4
ICICI Pru Nifty Auto ETF	3.0	4.4	4.5	4.7	5.0	4.9	6.9	6.8	6.7	7.3	7.7	7.2
ICICI Pru Nifty Metal ETF	2.0	2.0	2.0	2.0	2.1	2.2	9.3	9.8	7.2	6.9	6.9	6.6
ICICI Pru Nifty Bank ETF	16.6	12.6	11.5	11.1	11.2	12.0	14.8	14.3	14.2	8.5	6.0	5.9
Tri-Party Repo (TREPS) & Net Current Asset	1.4	3.1	2.3	2.5	2.8	3.9	3.4	3.6	5.0	3.3	2.2	3.4
Motilal Oswal Nifty Realty ETF			1.2	1.2	1.2	1.8	3.1	3.0	2.6	2.6	3.5	3.8
CPSE ETF	2.7	2.7	2.6	2.5	2.7	2.6						
ICICI Pru Nifty Healthcare ETF	9.8	9.8	10.2	10.0	9.7	7.8						
ICICI Pru Nifty India Consumption ETF	8.8	8.7	8.8	9.2	9.2	9.0						
ICICI Pru Nifty Infrastructure ETF	7.6	7.6	7.5	7.4	7.4	6.1						
ICICI Pru Nifty Commodities ETF	3.5	4.5	4.5	4.8	5.0	4.1						

Source: ACEMF

Take a T-bill and chill

GLOBAL VIEW. Money-market funds have become the go-to spot for everyone — from retail savers to corporate treasurers

Bloomberg

The stock market keeps setting records. Bitcoin has minted millionaires. Gold has peaked at new levels. Yet one of the most popular trades is to sit in cash or, more precisely, money-market funds. These plain-vanilla vehicles, which invest in short-term debt, have become the default parking spot for everyone from retail savers to corporate treasurers.

The US money-market industry now holds a record \$8.29 trillion — almost twice the size of Japan’s economy — after inflows topped \$1 trillion last year, according to Crane Data LLC, which tracks the industry. The strategy’s popularity has been accompanied by a Wall Street catchphrase, “T-bill and chill,” which has come to signify investors’ preference for the short-term Treasuries these funds often hold.

“Convenience is king with cash,” says Peter Crane, President of Crane Data. “It’s the ultimate hedge when other assets like Bitcoin and gold have done more going up and going down.” Stability in finance has been rare over the past decade. The

volatility has pushed safety-minded investors toward money-market funds, where the appeal is the combination of stability and returns. Yields on the 100 largest funds were near 3.5 per cent at the end of April, according to a Crane Data index.

With long-dated bonds still sensitive to shifts in interest-rate expectations, many savers have gravitated toward short-term vehicles instead. Money-market funds aim to maintain a stable \$1 share price and adjust to changes in rates more quickly than bank deposits.

MOVING TOWARDS CASH

Jessica Perrone, who’s spent 16 years as a financial professional and teaches personal finance, says two kinds of savers are moving toward cash. High-net-worth households — the type juggling Summer spending, second homes and market highs — are reacting to climbing oil prices and corporate margins that look vulnerable. But she’s also noticing a shift among everyday workers in her financial-wellness workshops, as conflicting headlines and market volatility push people to park their money in more predictable assets.

Investors are calculating that

GROWING SHIFT

With long-dated bonds still sensitive to shifts in interest rate expectation, many savers have moved toward short-term vehicles

they can get a decent yield with no risk “or maybe 5.5-6 per cent elsewhere with the possibility of losses,” says Jeff Judge, a Managing Partner at Chesapeake Financial Planners.

To Amrita Bhasin, a 25-year-old tech worker in California, money-market funds feel easier to manage than, say, certificates of deposit, where cash is locked

up for a specific period and subject to penalties.

Judge has seen higher demand for cashlike instruments among younger investors, while Laurie Brignac, Chief Investment Officer at asset manager Invesco, says the preference is also strong among American baby boomers. While they’re not necessarily disinvesting from risk assets, she says, “their investments are kicking off more cash,” and the gains get redirected to safer holdings. Overall, money-market funds made up almost 4.5 per cent of total wealth at the end of 2025, according to Federal Reserve data, compared with about 3 per cent prior to the hiking cycle that began a decade earlier.

Even incoming Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh says he plans to keep much of his own wealth in such vehicles.

SAFEGUARD FLEXIBILITY

Businesses, meanwhile, are piling into the trend to safeguard flexibility for investment and strategic moves. Non-financial companies had amassed almost \$6.2 trillion in cash and short-term instruments at the end of 2025, according to SMBC Nikko Securities America Inc., up 4 per cent. Joseph Abate, Head of the

Tonic for the patient investor

PHARMACEUTICALS. Cipla’s well-laid plans are likely to drive a gradual recovery from headwinds that impacted it in FY26

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Cipla has been impacted by the loss of sales in two main products in the US market in FY26. The new launches, supposed to offset the loss, have not taken off as expected. We earlier recommended investors accumulate the stock in March 2025, from where it has declined 8 per cent to date. The launch outlook for FY27 appears robust, with a couple of approvals in place and the management guiding for launches across FY27-28.

We reiterate our accumulate call for investors with a three-five year perspective in view of the launch pipeline for the US and Indian markets. Currently, the stock is trading at a one-year forward PE of 25 times (based on Bloomberg consensus estimates), which is close to its five-year average of 24 times. With earnings growth expected to accelerate to a 16 per cent CAGR in FY26-28 from a 3 per cent decline in FY24-26, valuations appear comfortable.

INDIA, OTHER MARKETS

India, Africa, and Emerging and European (EMEU) markets account for a significant share of revenues and have delivered strong growth.

The Indian operation driven by branded generics, trade generics (*Jan Aushadhi*) and consumer health have reported strong growth in FY26 and are expected to continue. The branded division in FY27 will be supported by the Eli Lilly partnered launch of Mounjaro (Tirzepatide), branded as Yurpeak for weight-loss and diabetes.

The company has also launched Empagliflozin and Afrezza (inhaled insulin) in the diabetes category and acquired three brands from Pfizer. The leadership position in respiratory, growth in cardiology and diabetes, and a steady in-licensed portfolio should sustain low double-digit growth. A steady introduction of products from India and the US markets



as branded generics in Africa and normal generics in EMEU should similarly drive strong growth in the regions.

THE US PIPELINE

The US revenues declined 16 per cent year on year to \$780 million in FY26. A large portion of the drop was expected, as generic Revlimid sales were expected to drop from January 2026. But generic Lanreotide (\$100 million or more of sales per year for Cipla in the US) was also stopped, as the manufacturing partner Pharmathen faced FDA inspections and manufacturing was halted. The company is working on two alternate suppliers, but the sales are expected to recover in early FY28 or so.

But Cipla has guided for FY27 US sales’ exit run-rate of \$1 billion, which implies hitting \$250 million per quarter towards the fiscal-end. The company is eyeing the launch of four respiratory generics in FY27, of which it has the approval for gVentolin and expects to launch in the coming months. The long-awaited gAdvair, used in the treatment of asthma, is also expected along with gSymbicort and two more (undisclosed) in the year. The known assets have a large addressable market (\$500-1,000 million) and low competition (around two-four market players including the innovator), and each product has the potential to generate \$75-100 million in the first year of

● **ACCUMULATE**

Cipla ₹1,400.70

WHY

- Valuations in line on lower earnings
- FY27, a crucial year for launches
- Margin recovery to be gradual with enough levers

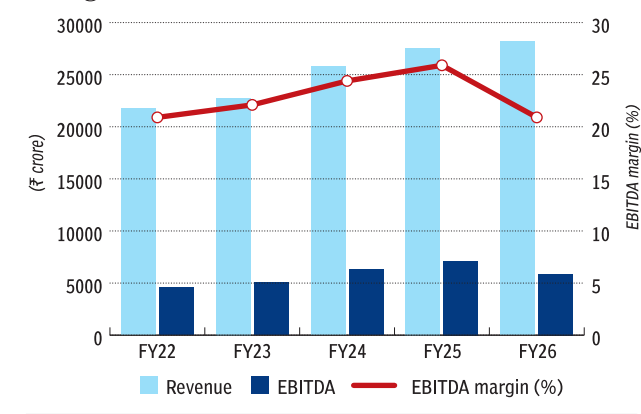
launch. Similar to Lanreotide, Cipla hopes to launch eight peptide or complex generics (three in FY27) as well.

Loss of sales from Revlimid and Lanreotide will be felt for two-three quarters in FY27 as well. But the company’s aim to reach \$250 million per quarter by FY27-end seems plausible depending on the launches and execution. Cipla will look to have four more respiratory filings and three more peptide/complex generics filings in FY28. It has also started on biosimilars (drugs derived from living organisms) with the first launch of a biosimilar in the US – filgrastim, and more products under study.

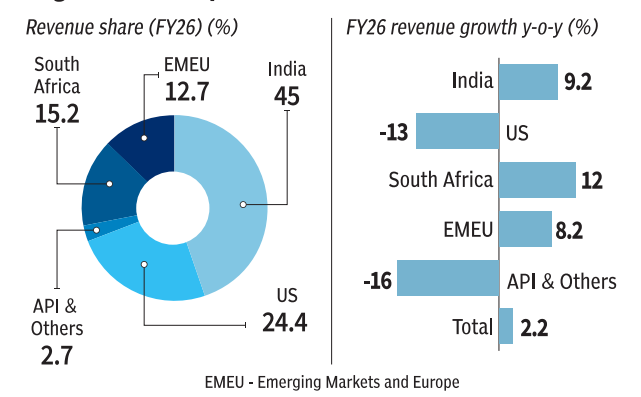
FINANCIALS, VALUATION

While Cipla revenues have declined 2.2 per cent in FY26 to ₹28,163 crore, the EBITDA margin has contracted by 500 bps to 20.9 per cent in FY26 owing to

Margin headwinds can be overcome



Segment breakup



the gRevlimid loss. This resulted in EBITDA contracting around 17 per cent in FY26. The company expects an EBITDA margin of 18.5-20 per cent in FY27 owing to the loss and higher R&D expenses.

The R&D expenses as a percentage of sales have increased 150 bps to 7 per cent in FY26 and are expected to remain in the range in FY27. The pipeline, including biosimilars, Oligonucleotides, peptides and respiratory products, are cost-intensive, as expenses relating to studies, filings and development are expected to be higher. Even costs of employees and other expenses as a percentage of sales have increased 200 bps in FY26 owing to both lower revenues and higher absolute costs to support the larger infrastructure.

Cipla now operates a respiratory plant in the US along with remediation expenses (the Goa

plant faced FDA inspections, while the Indore plant is expecting inspection). The company has levers to improve its EBITDA margins beyond FY27 either through higher revenue base (from the launches) or by a cost-control exercise. More importantly, the \$1-billion exit run-rate excludes any contribution from Lanreotide, which could show up in FY28.

Current Bloomberg consensus estimates for FY27 revenue, EBITDA and PAT growth are 11.1 per cent and 10 per cent, respectively.

Additionally, the company has negligible debt and a net cash position of ₹10,526 crore (9 per cent of market cap) as of March 2026. The new management, after the departure of long-term CEO Umang Vohra, might be conservative in deploying cash, but the company has fire power to add an inorganic growth lever as well.

Good time to take a re-look

BANKING. Kotak Mahindra Bank’s stock trades at over 30 per cent discount to its five-year mean P/B multiple

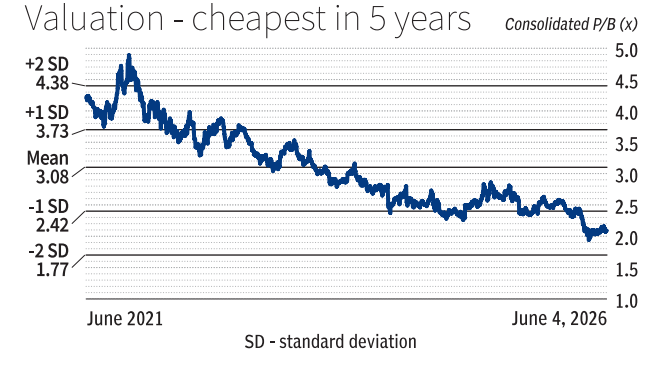
Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

Since our last ‘accumulate’ call on Kotak Mahindra Bank (KMB) in August 2025 at around ₹399 per share, the stock has stayed flat. This is largely to do with the stock’s FY26 financial results, which were ordinary. The profit (before one-offs) of the standalone bank grew 2 per cent over FY25 and that of the group remained flat. This was largely due to margin compression and certain asset-quality issues at the bank. The bank accounts for three-fourths of the consolidated net worth. Net interest margin (NIM) declined from 4.96 per cent for FY25 to 4.6 per cent for FY26. Provisions were elevated and recorded a growth of 18 per cent year on year. Performance of key subsidiaries also was not remarkable enough to write home about.

However, by Q4 FY26, with tighter underwriting, the bank has manoeuvred those asset-quality concerns well and they are largely behind. Collection efficiency has improved in the impacted segments of microfinance, credit cards and retail commercial vehicles and going ahead, the bank is confident to scale these products once again. Asset quality is expected to be stable in FY27, save for any surprises in store, driven by trade disruptions or weather-related causes in SME, agri and tractor finance segments. These portfolios are performing well at the moment, though.

NIM could see slight decline in FY27 too, as the bank is pursuing longer-tenor term deposits at the cost of margin. However, there are a few levers to offset this, as detailed here. The upcoming ECL (expected credit loss) framework from FY28 is likely to impact the bank’s net worth by 2 per cent, per the management.

These meant the group’s price-to-book value (P/B) multiple shrank from 2.5x at the time of our earlier call to about 2.1x now — 1.5 standard devi-



Conservative SOTP valuation

Business	Valuation methodology	Per share value in ₹
Kotak Mahindra Bank (standalone banking business)	2x current book value	265
Unlisted wholly-owned subsidiaries	Kotak Securities	#20x TTM PAT 33
	Kotak Mahindra AMC	*0.06x QAAUM 36
	Kotak Mahindra Prime	≈2x current book value 22
	Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance	*2x embedded value 39
Total		395

#Based on the P/E multiples of key listed peers; *Based on the market cap to quarterly average AUM ratio of key listed peers; #Based on the P/B multiples of key listed peers; *Based on the market cap to embedded value ratio of key listed peers

ations below the five-year mean of 3.1x. The accompanying infographic contains the SOTP (sum-of-the-parts) price of the stock, worked with conservative assumptions — a multiple of just 2x has been ascribed for the bank (vs 2.5x in our earlier call).

At this price, the stock appears fairly valued. However, going forward, given credit costs could remain benign in the backdrop of good balance sheet mo-

FY26 PERFORMANCE

The standalone bank first. In FY26, KMB’s advances grew 16.2 per cent year on year, in-line with the banking system. It gained market share in deposits though, growing at 14.7 per cent, against the system’s 13.5

per cent. CASA balances deserve a mention. They grew 15.5 per cent, higher than private banking peer HDFC’s 12.3 per cent and ICICI’s 10.4 per cent. CASA ratio was resilient at 43.3 per cent vs 43 per cent as of FY25-end.

Most segments of the loan book recorded healthy growth except for three: Unsecured personal loans (3 per cent), credit cards (-8 per cent) and microfinance (-8 per cent). These were the ones with asset-quality concerns as said above and notably, they carry relatively higher yields, padding NIM. They largely form the unsecured book of the bank, which now stands at 8.9 per cent of the loan book from 10.5 per cent, a year ago. However, things are looking up. The personal loan book has been growing sequentially for the past couple quarters. After quarter-on-quarter (q-o-q) declines in Q1 and Q2 FY26, microfinance book arrested degrowth in Q3 and grew sequentially in Q4. Credit cards shrunk in Q1-Q3, but remained flat in Q4 on a q-o-q basis. The bank had been revamping its credit card line-up and now that it is done, the portfolio is ready for scaling up. Slippages (1.6 per cent of advances in Q1 FY26) and credit cost (0.9 per cent of advances in Q1 FY26) improved through the quarters to healthy levels of 0.8 per cent and 0.4 per cent respectively, as of Q4 FY26. GNPA ratio stands at 1.2 per cent down from 1.4 per cent a year ago. The management is, however, watchful of the above

segments, in addition to SME, Agri and Tractor finance, as they are the most vulnerable in case of a macro stress.

FY26 standalone profit grew a marginal 2 per cent (before one-offs) and RoA slid to 1.97 per cent from 2.2 per cent in FY25. This was primarily driven by an 18 per cent rise in provisions (largely from unsecured book), loss of fee income from credit cards and NIM compression of about 50 bps (4.6 per cent for FY26 from 4.96 for FY25). KMB’s NIM decline (about 30 bps) is greater than peers HDFC and ICICI, who have gone through this rate transmission cycle with negligible impact on NIMs (Q4 FY26 vs Q3 FY25). Poor growth in the unsecured book is the key reason.

NIM PUSH AND PULLS

Going into FY27, NIM could further contract but gradually, owing to higher rates offered for longer-tenor term deposits (longer than the bank’s current average tenor of 9-12 months) than competitors. This is KMB’s strategy to navigate the current deposit drought. However, there are levers to offset this. One, the restart in unsecured book could bring in higher yields. Two, good momentum is seen in low-cost CASA deposits as mentioned above. Any increment to the CASA ratio will aid propping margin.

SUBSIDIARIES

Capital market subsidiaries were impacted by FII outflows, geopolitics, trade disruption and a general weakness in the market. Kotak Securities (brokerage) and Kotak Mahindra Capital (investment bank) recorded no profit growth. Kotak AMC managed double-digit profit growth (11 per cent) and an AUM expansion of 22 per cent.

Net profit of vehicle finance subsidiary Kotak Mahindra Prime, too, did not grow owing to marked-to-market losses. Its loan book grew 12 per cent. Life Insurance subsidiary’s embedded value rose 9.2 per cent.

Taking Stock • bl • 5

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	May 29	June 5		
Titan	4,074.7	4,260.0	▲	4.5
Infosys	1,159.8	1,197.0	▲	3.2
Eternal	250.9	256.5	▲	2.2
SBI	964.0	977.8	▲	1.4
Tata Motors PV	393.3	397.7	▲	1.1
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,804.8	1,823.1	▲	1.0
ICICI Bank	1,256.0	1,262.2	▲	0.5
Asian Paints	2,672.1	2,685.2	▲	0.5
HDFC Bank	744.8	747.4	▲	0.3
M & M	3,034.8	3,040.8	▲	0.2
Tech Mahindra	1,483.2	1,482.7	▼	0.0
Maruti Suzuki	13,119.9	13,048.6	▼	-0.5
Bharat Electronics	410.9	408.1	▼	-0.7
Sun Pharma	1,800.9	1,783.6	▼	-1.0
Tata Steel	208.9	206.8	▼	-1.0
Axis Bank	1,287.9	1,273.2	▼	-1.1
HUL	2,146.0	2,120.8	▼	-1.2
Power Grid	289.8	285.4	▼	-1.5
Trent	2,820.4	2,774.7	▼	-1.6
Bharti Airtel	1,829.7	1,799.0	▼	-1.7
Bajaj Finance	904.7	889.2	▼	-1.7
Kotak Mahindra Bank	384.7	377.5	▼	-1.9
ITC	287.0	280.8	▼	-2.2
Reliance Industries	1,320.6	1,291.2	▼	-2.2
TCS	2,253.9	2,198.3	▼	-2.5
HCL Tech	1,184.4	1,154.5	▼	-2.5
L&T	4,076.7	3,954.0	▼	-3.0
Bajaj Finserv	1,784.7	1,703.1	▼	-4.6
UltraTech Cement	11,449.3	10,910.8	▼	-4.7
NTPC	386.8	361.7	▼	-6.5

How sectoral indices moved

	May 29	June 5	Movement	% change
CONSUMER DURABLES	57,686.0	58,654.5	▲	1.7
BANKEX	61,131.3	61,478.6	▲	0.6
HEALTHCARE	46,806.4	46,908.4	▲	0.2
IT	28,165.1	28,221.2	▲	0.2
TECK	14,930.3	14,907.9	▼	-0.2
PSU	20,937.6	20,815.3	▼	-0.6
AUTO	57,983.4	57,632.9	▼	-0.6
OIL&GAS	26,741.0	26,555.6	▼	-0.7
CAPITAL GOODS	80,818.7	80,010.9	▼	-1.0
METALS	43,765.8	43,212.5	▼	-1.3
FMCG	18,264.7	17,926.8	▼	-1.8
REALTY	6,115.2	5,995.8	▼	-2.0
POWER	8,383.1	8,135.3	▼	-3.0

How other indices moved

BANK NIFTY	54,239.2	54,496.3	▲	0.5
NIFTY 500	22,657.0	22,465.4	▼	-0.8
NIFTY 100	24,608.5	24,397.3	▼	-0.9
NIFTY 200	13,663.7	13,527.0	▼	-1.0
NIFTY NEXT 50	71,073.7	70,192.0	▼	-1.2

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 While I have been around for little over a decade, my billionaire founder has been in the industry for more than four decades.
- 2 I am the largest manufacturer in the world in several products. While I am still a small-cap stock, I have signed an exclusive agreement with a trillion-dollar market-cap company.
- 3 While almost half my revenues come from exports, more than half my exports are to advanced economies in Europe.
- 4 I am one of the few bootstrapped successes of recent years and all four founders from the family remain on the dozen-member board.
- 5 While the response to my IPO was lacklustre and retail subscription was just about one time, I have delivered about 100 per cent returns to them since then.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week’s stock:
JK Paper
Last week’s winner:
Dr Kishor Kumar Shetty

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,367) lost 0.8 per cent over the past week, while Nifty Bank (54,496) managed to gain 0.5 per cent. However, the derivatives data suggest that the broader market sentiment has weakened, primarily due to a rise in bearish positioning by institutional investors.

FII (foreign institutional investors) increased their net short exposure on index futures by 33 per cent to 2.68 lakh contracts over the last week. They also raised net short positions on index call options by 2 per cent to 2.76 lakh contracts and increased net long positions in index puts by 15 per cent to 5.30 lakh contracts, indicating a stronger preference for downside protection.

The broader positioning, including retail participation, also turned weaker. Combined net short positions on index futures increased from 47,877 contracts to 59,258 contracts. Likewise, net short positions on call options expanded 51 per cent to 1.89 lakh contracts. At the same time, net put shorts declined 13 per cent to 2.81 lakh contracts, suggesting reduced willingness among traders to defend lower levels.

The derivatives data mirror the divergence seen in the indices. Nifty appears relatively weaker as traders have added fresh bearish positions, whereas Bank Nifty has managed to hold up better. That said, the latter is yet to exhibit signs of a sustained recovery. Overall, market positioning points to strengthening bearish sentiment, with Nifty carrying a greater degree of weakness than Bank Nifty.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (June) (23,452) declined sharply on Monday and thereafter traded largely within a range for the rest of the week.

Cash-flow factor in BTST trades

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. You cannot use the capital blocked in the cash segment till the next day

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously, we discussed Buy Today Sell Tomorrow (BTST) trades. We showed why futures are preferable to options for initiating BTST trades. This week, we discuss another aspect of the BTST trade: why futures are preferable to the spot (cash) market.

FUTURES VS CASH

An obvious benefit of trading futures over cash market is that the former is a leveraged trade. That is, you are required to only post initial margin when you initiate the position and mark to market margin, when the position moves adversely. You must pay the full contract value only if you keep the position open till expiry. Transactions in the cash market, on the other hand, require payment of full contract value when the trade is executed.

Also, based on the current SEBI regulation, BTST trades initiated in the cash market have a cash flow disadvantage compared to that in the futures market. Suppose you go long on a stock on Monday and sell the

Signals weakness

BULLION CUES. Recovery may face hurdles

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Prices of precious metals declined sharply last week. Gold (\$4,328/ounce) and silver (\$67.8/ounce) was down 5 and 10 per cent respectively. In the domestic market, gold futures (August) (₹1,55,594/10 gm) dropped 3.3 per cent and silver futures (July) (₹2,48,537/kg) lost 7 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,55,594)
Gold futures (August) were trading flat for most part of last week. But on Friday, the contract witnessed a strong downtrend, breaching a trendline support and closing below both 21- and 50-day moving averages.

The above factors have increased the strength of the bears, which can potentially drag the price further lower to ₹1,52,000. Even if it recovers from the current level, it is likely to be arrested at ₹1,59,000.

A breakout of ₹1,59,000 can lift the contract to ₹1,62,800.

Trade strategy: Traders can short gold futures at ₹1,57,500. Place stop-loss at ₹1,59,500. Revise this down to ₹1,56,000 when



The contract eventually ended the week with a loss of 1.3 per cent. Consequently, the short position that we had recommended at 23,925 was not triggered.

While Nifty June futures fell 1.3 per cent last week, its Open Interest (OI) increased 16 per cent to 199 lakh contracts, indicating fresh short build-up. Reinforcing the bearish bias, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of June options declined from 1.17 to 1.03, as traders reduced put writing and added fresh call shorts.

Overall, the derivatives data point to a weakening outlook for Nifty futures.

That said, the chart shows that

- AT A GLANCE**
- FII net shorts increase
 - Nifty Bank holds up better
 - Breakdown levels under watch

Nifty futures (June) is currently trapped within a range of 23,250-23,650. Given the prevailing derivatives positioning and the recent bearish trend, the probability of a breakdown below 23,250 appears higher.

A breach of 23,250 can trigger a decline to 23,000 and sub-

sequently to 22,600. On the other hand, if Nifty futures breaks out of 23,650, it can witness a relief rally towards 23,850. A breakout above 23,850 can extend the upswing to 24,150.

Strategy: Go short on Nifty futures (June) if the contract breaks down below 23,250. Place stop-loss at 23,550 and book profits at 22,600.

Alternatively, if Nifty futures rises to 23,800, initiate fresh shorts with a stop-loss at 24,200. Book profits at 23,000.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (June) (54,782), unlike Nifty futures, recovered strongly after witnessing a decline in the early part of last week. The contract recouped all the losses and eventually ended the week broadly flat.

The OI of June futures increased by a marginal 2 per cent to 25.72 lakh contracts. Likewise, the PCR of June options remained largely unchanged at 0.92. Therefore, the derivatives positioning does not offer any strong directional cues at the moment.

The chart shows that Nifty Bank futures, currently at 54,782, is trading within a broad range of 53,150-55,800. Hence, for reliable clues on the next leg of the trend, the contract must move out of this range.

A breakout above 55,800 can open the door for a rally to 56,750 and subsequently to 57,500. On the other hand, if the contract breaks below the support at 53,150, the sell-off can intensify, potentially dragging it to 51,800.

Strategy: Nifty Bank futures (June) made a low of 53,287.60 on June 3 before witnessing a sharp recovery. Consequently, the contract came close to our target of 53,200 before reversing sharply.

Traders can continue to hold the short position with the stop-loss and target retained at 55,300 and 53,200 respectively.

to single-stock futures for BTST trades, given that index futures are cash-settled whereas singles-stock futures are delivery based? It does not matter as BTST trade requires you close the position during early trade on the day of expiry. So, the choice between index futures and single-stock futures should be based on your view of the underlying.

OPTIONAL READING

Using futures over the cash segment is primarily a cash flow strategy. Note that we compare cash and carry trade with futures and not trades that you can initiate using margin trading facility. Given the leverage benefits and the release of margins, you can use your trading capital effectively if you use futures. But futures are available only on a specified list of securities. What if you identify good opportunities to set up BTST trades on other stocks? It may, therefore, be optimal to allocate a predetermined proportion of your trading capital for such trades.

The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments

Upside remains capped

CRUDE CHECK. Further downside likely

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices gained over the last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$93.10/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,614/barrel) were up 2.2 per cent and 4 per cent respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$93.10)
Brent crude oil futures rallied in the first half of last week to hit a high of \$98.99 on Wednesday. But in the following sessions, the price dropped. Nevertheless, the contract managed to post a weekly gain.

That said, the chart shows that the price band of \$98-100 is a strong resistance and so long as the price remains below this level, the outlook will be bearish. As it stands, the probability for a decline to \$88 is high.

On the other hand, in case Brent crude futures breaks out of \$100, it can extend the uptick to \$105 and \$114.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹8,614)
Crude oil futures (June) saw an uptick in price during the first



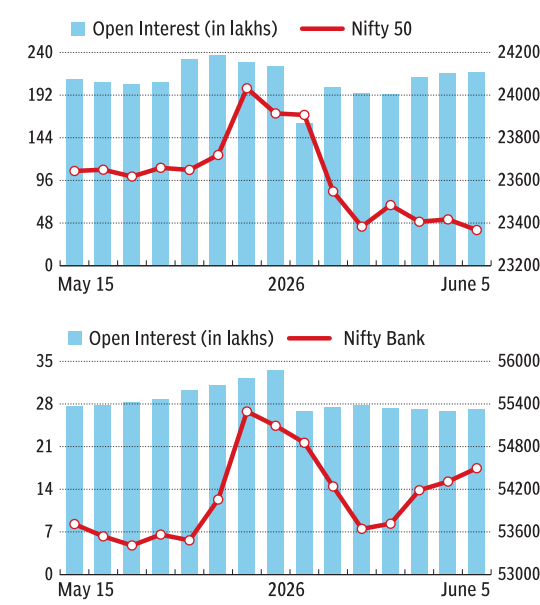
half of last week and marked a high of ₹9,290 on Wednesday. But then, the bears took over, leading to a notable decline in price.

The prevailing price action shows that the bears are gaining traction and the probability of further fall in price is high. From the current level, we expect crude oil futures to decline to ₹7,600. A breach of this can result in a deeper fall to ₹7,000.

For the contract to change the outlook positive, it ought to decisively break out of the barrier at ₹9,500, which appears less likely. If it happens, then crude oil futures can retest the prior high of ₹10,150.

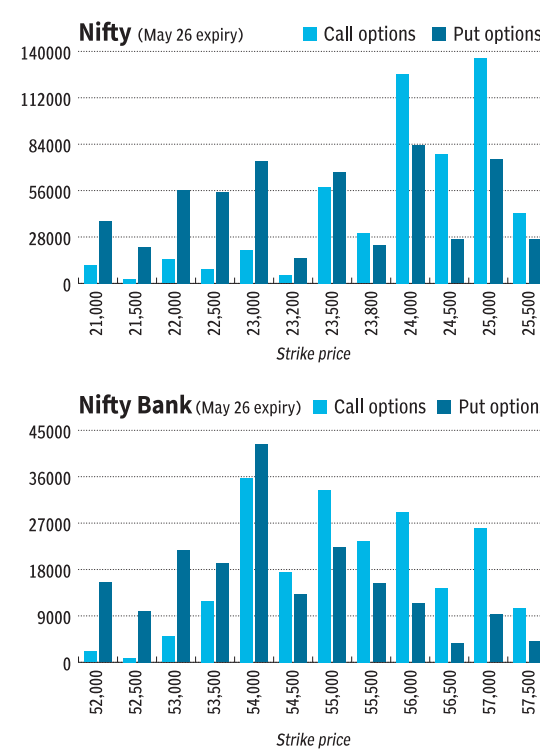
Trade strategy: Short crude oil futures at ₹8,800 with a stop-loss at ₹9,400 for a target of ₹7,600.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.03** | Nifty Bank **0.92** (as on June 5)



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Jun 5	Weekly change %	As on Jun 5	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	25958	-18	286458	18
Future Index Short	293664	26	78010	-12
Net Futures	-267706	33	208448	36
Index Call options Long	591082	7	3219313	1
Index Call options Short	867141	5	3132182	2
Net Call options	-276059	2	87131	-40
Index Put options Long	977772	16	2249212	19
Index Put options Short	447544	17	3060615	15
Net Put Options	530228	15	-811403	3

FII have increased net short on index futures and net short on call options. They've also increased net long on puts. Overall, the bias is bearish.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Jun 5)				
GVT&D	5,067.00	-1.6	14.5	277.9
NHPC	74.97	-4.9	3367.4	99.1
RADICO	3,490.70	-0.8	3.2	91.7
TRENT	2,774.20	-1.5	153.0	81.7
NAM-INDIA	1,113.10	1.2	79.0	68.5
FALL (as on Jun 5)				
BDL	1,207.40	0.2	141.0	-10.4
HYUNDAI	1,913.60	-0.5	95.7	-10.2
LICHSGFIN	549.75	3.1	386.9	-3.2
SAMMAANCAP	184.28	4.1	1260.5	-1.3
GRASIM	3,087.70	-1.1	173.2	-0.5

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Jun 8)

AMBER	KAYNES
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Jun 5)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Jun	384.4 (-0.4)	3,626 (-9)	Long unwinding
COPPER	30-Jun	1,336.2 (0.4)	16,896 (2448)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	18-Jun	8,614.0 (4.0)	10,572 (-15)	Short covering
CRUDEOILM	18-Jun	8,616.0 (4.0)	28,441 (-18)	Short covering
GOLD	5-Aug	1,55,594.0 (-3.3)	8,807 (13)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Jun	1,24,034.0 (-2.6)	14,354 (11)	Short build-up
GOLDM	3-Jul	1,53,712.0 (-2.9)	49,812 (37)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Jun	15,530.0 (-2.7)	1,91,737 (10)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Jun	1,54,097.0 (-2.8)	32,787 (20)	Short build-up
LEAD	30-Jun	206.7 (-0.1)	404 (11)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	25-Jun	308.6 (-2.3)	15,142 (-22)	Long unwinding
SILVER	3-Jul	2,48,537.0 (-6.9)	12,315 (22)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,54,631.0 (-6.2)	27,284 (20)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,54,771.0 (-6.2)	78,208 (33)	Short build-up
ZINC	30-Jun	365.0 (0.0)	2,627 (8)	Short build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Jun 5)				
USDINR	25-Jun	95.14 (-0.1)	26,79,387 (55)	Short build-up
EURINR	25-Jun	110.86 (-0.3)	13,150 (-9)	Long unwinding
GBPINR	25-Jun	128.23 (0.1)	33,165 (-1)	Short covering
JPYINR	25-Jun	60.02 (0.0)	81 (3)	-

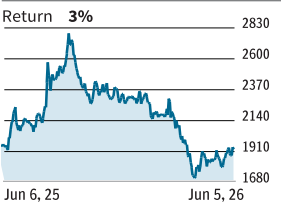
F&O Strategy

Short Hyundai Motor

KS Badri Narayanan

Hyundai Motor India (HMIL) (₹1,913.60) is ruling at a crucial level. Immediate resistance levels are at ₹1,990 and ₹2,177. A close above the latter will turn the outlook positive. Nearest supports are ₹1,844 and ₹1,783.

As long as the stock remains above ₹1,691, the long-term bullish outlook will stay. However, in the short term, we expect the stock to decline.



F&O pointers: HMIL June futures closed at ₹1,929 and July futures at ₹1,931 against the spot price of ₹1,913.60. The June contracts also shed open positions in the last few days, capturing the cautiousness of traders. Option trading indicates that the stock could move between ₹1,800 and ₹2,120.

Strategy: Go short on HMIL futures with stop-loss at ₹1,940. Shift the stop-loss to ₹1,920 if the stock opens on a flat or negative note. Traders can aim for an initial target of ₹1,905. Traders with higher risk tolerance can aim for ₹1,895. This strategy is only for traders who can understand the risk in futures and can meet margin obligations comfortably.

For lower risk, traders can buy 1900-put that closed with a premium of ₹51.05. As the market lot is 275 shares, this strategy would cost traders ₹14,038.75, which would be the maximum loss. While initial stop loss can be ₹45, this can be shifted to ₹51 if the stock opens flat or negative. Target can be ₹60.

Follow-up: Trade recommendation on Ashok Leyland hit the target.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Dividend & F&O adjustments

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Three stocks – Infosys, Punjab National Bank (PNB) and Canara Bank – will undergo changes in derivative contracts this week. The adjustments are done to reflect the dividend announced.

While the record date for Infosys is June 10, the same for PNB and Canara Bank is on June 12. These are the respective dates from which the changes will be effective in the futures and options contracts of these stocks.



Infosys: The dividend is ₹25. Since June 10 is the record date and suppose Infosys June futures closes at ₹1,200 on June 9 (settlement price of the day prior to the record date will be considered for adjustments), the price will be modified to ₹1,175 (₹1,200 minus ₹25). In options, for example, the strike prices ₹1,200 and ₹1,250 will become ₹1,175 and ₹1,225, respectively.

PNB: The dividend is ₹3. Suppose PNB June futures ends at ₹105 on June 11 (day prior to record date), the contract price will be modified to ₹102. In options, for example, strikes of 105 and 100 will be adjusted to 102 and 97, respectively.

Canara Bank: The dividend is ₹4.2. Suppose Canara Bank June futures closes at ₹130 on June 11 (day prior to record date), the contract price will be modified to ₹125.80. In options, for example, strikes of 125 and 130 will be adjusted to 120.80 and 125.80 respectively.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index fell in the first half last week. Nifty and Sensex remained stable in the second half and closed about 0.7 per cent down each. Nifty Bank index, on the other hand, bounced back well, recovering all the loss. It closed the week higher by 0.47 per cent.

There is a divergence visible on the chart. Nifty has more room to fall. Sensex is very close to a key support. Nifty Bank index is already holding well above its support and has a good chance to rise from current levels itself. Broadly based on the recent price action, it looks like the Nifty Bank index can outperform in the coming weeks.

FPIS SELL

The foreign portfolio investors' (FPIs') selling spree continues. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$4.5 billion last week. We reiterate that the FPIs have to come back strongly into the domestic market in order to boost the Nifty and Sensex.

NIFTY 50 (23,366.70)

Short-term view: Nifty is struggling to rise past 23,500 decisively. That keeps the bias weak. Nifty can fall to 23,000-22,900. If the index manages to bounce from this region, it can rise again towards 23,400-23,500.

But a failure to bounce back and a break below 22,900 can trigger an extended fall to 22,400. However, a fall beyond 22,400 is less likely now in the absence of any new negative trigger.

Key resistance is at 23,850. Nifty has to surpass this hurdle in order to ease the downside pressure. Only then a rise to 24,300-24,700 will come into the picture.

Medium-term view: As mentioned last week, Nifty is now coming down within its broad 22,000-26,500 range. We expect this range to remain intact. As such, the downside can be limited to 22,000 if the index declines below 22,400.

We retain our bullish bias of getting a breakout above 26,500 in the coming months. That can take the Nifty higher to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

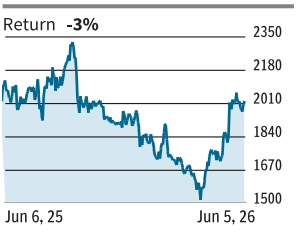
The bullish view will go wrong only if the Nifty declines below 22,000.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Caplin Point Laboratories (₹2,031.45)

Bulls to regain traction

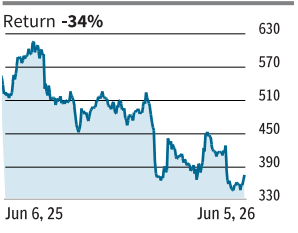


Since early April, the stock of Caplin Point Laboratories has been in a steady uptrend. Three weeks ago, it surpassed a resistance at ₹1,960. While there was no follow-through rally post the breakout, the stock was able to sustain above this level, indicating that the bulls retain the upper hand.

Now that the stock has seen some consolidation, we expect it to begin the uptrend soon. The scrip shows potential to rally to ₹2,350. Hence, participants can buy the stock now at ₹2,031 and accumulate at ₹1,960. Place stop-loss at ₹1,900. When the price rises to ₹2,200 and ₹2,300, revise the stop-loss to ₹2,050 and ₹2,200 respectively. Exit at ₹2,350.

Kalyan Jewellers India (₹371.80)

Short-term trend turns positive

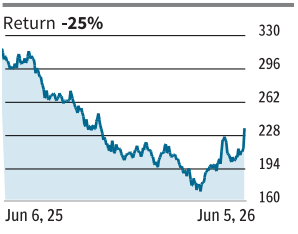


The stock has been in a downtrend since January 2025. However, the scrip has been consolidating for nearly three weeks. But last week, the price rallied 4.6 per cent and broke out of ₹362. This confirmed the double-bottom chart pattern, indicating a bullish trend reversal, at least for the short term.

The chart set hints at a rally to ₹415. Therefore, traders can go long now at ₹371 and buy more shares if the price declines to ₹362. Place stop-loss at ₹345. When the price rallies to ₹390, raise the stop-loss to ₹370. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹390 when the stock moves up to ₹400. Liquidate the longs at ₹415.

Quess Corp (₹235.80)

Trend turns positive



The stock appreciated over 13 per cent last week. Consequently, it surpassed the barrier at ₹225. Also, the price has risen above the 21- and 50-day moving averages. From the current level, the price is likely to drop to ₹218. But then, the stock can resume the uptrend and appreciate to ₹320 over the medium term. That said, when the price goes up to ₹285, we might see the stock consolidate around this level before surpassing it and rise to ₹320. Traders can buy now at ₹235 and accumulate at ₹218. Place stop-loss at ₹195. When the stock hits ₹285 and ₹300, revise the stop-loss to ₹265 and ₹285, respectively. Exit at ₹320.

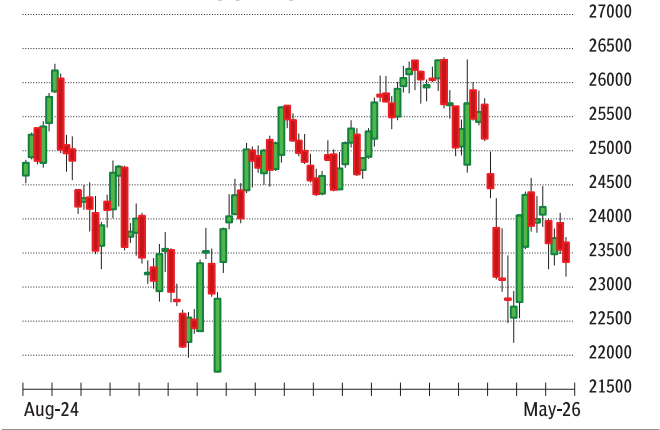
Poles apart

INDEX OUTLOOK. Nifty Bank indicates potential to rise while Nifty and Sensex have room to fall



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Nifty 50: Struggling to rise back



KEY SUPPORTS

- Nifty 50: 22,900, 22,400
- Sensex: 72,700, 71,500
- Nifty Bank: 53,750, 52,500

decline below this support to indicate a trend reversal.

SENSEX (74,243.34)

Short-term view: The near-term picture is still weak. However, there is limited room to fall from here compared to the Nifty. Support is in the 73,000-72,700 region which can limit the downside.

Sensex can bounce from this support zone and rise back to 74,500 initially. An eventual break above 74,500 will then clear the way for a further rise to 76,000-76,500.

Medium-term view: Crucial support is around 71,500-71,000. We expect the Sensex to sustain above this support and keep the 71,000-86,000 range intact.

Sensex can make a bullish breakout of this range eventu-

ally. Such a break will clear the way for a rally to 90,000 initially and 94,000 eventually over the long term.

Sensex has to decline below 71,000 to turn the outlook bearish and fall to 69,000.

ally. Such a break will clear the way for a rally to 90,000 initially and 94,000 eventually over the long term.

Sensex has to decline below 71,000 to turn the outlook bearish and fall to 69,000.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150

(22,251.80)

The index is stuck inside the 21,700-23,000 range over the last seven weeks. A breakout on either side of this range will determine the next move. A break below 21,700 can drag the index down to 21,500-21,400 or even 21,000. A fall beyond 21,000 is less likely.

On the other hand, a break above 23,000 can take the index higher to 23,100, a crucial resistance. The broader picture remains positive. As such, we retain our view of seeing a bullish breakout above 23,100 eventually. Such a break will take the Nifty Midcap 150 higher to 26,000-26,500 and 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the index declines below 20,800.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250

(17,054.50)

The support at 16,600 mentioned last week has held very well as expected. The index has risen back recovering all the loss from the low of 16,683.35. That keeps the overall bullish bias intact.

Short-term support is in the 16,400-16,200 region. The index can rise to 17,500 and even 18,000-18,300 in the coming weeks. We reiterate that 18,300 is a crucial resistance. The bias is positive to breach this hurdle eventually. That in turn will clear the way for the Nifty Smallcap250 index to rally to 22,500-23,000 and even 24,000 in the long term.

From a big picture perspective, the index has to decline below 14,000 to turn bearish, which looks unlikely.

bl.portfolio
video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week



Dollar gets a boost

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Equities knocked down on rate hike prospects

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index witnessed a strong sell-off on Friday. NASDAQ Composite tumbled over 4 per cent, while the S&P 500 and Dow Jones fell 2.5 per cent and 1.3 per cent respectively on Friday.

On the forex front, the dollar index and the Treasury yields got a boost on Friday from the jobs data release. The US added 172,000 jobs to its non-farm payroll in May. Market was expecting for an addition of 80,000 jobs. The unemployment rate remained stable at 4.3 per cent.

Strong job numbers are strengthening the case for a rate hike from the US Federal Reserve this year. That in turn has pushed the greenback and the yields higher on Friday.

DOW JONES (50,872.08)

The rise to 51,500 happened as expected, but the index has declined sharply from the high of 51,665.

Key supports are at 50,600 and 50,250. A bounce from either of these supports can take the Dow Jones higher to 51,500 again. It will also keep the upside open to see 52,500. However, as mentioned last week, 52,500 is a crucial resistance. It can halt the rally and trigger a reversal towards 51,000 and even lower.

In case the index breaks below 50,250 from here itself, then there is a danger of seeing a fall to 49,500-49,200. In that case, the chances of the rise to 52,500 will get negated.

S&P 500 (7,383.73)

Contrary to our expectation, the index has declined breaking below the support at 7,500. Crucial support is in the 7,330-7,300 region. The index has to sustain above this support and bounce back in order to go up to 7,450-7,500 again.

Failure to do so and a break below 7,300 will be bearish to see 7,150-7,100 on the downside. Such a fall will indicate that a top is in place.

Ideally, the S&P 500 index has to rise past 7,500 again to bring back the earlier bullishness. Only then the rise to 7,700-7,800 mentioned last week is possible.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (25,709.43)

As cautioned last week, a strong reversal has happened. We had expected the reversal from around 27,500. The NASDAQ Composite index has turned down after making a high of 27,190 itself.

Immediate support is at 25,650. A break below it can drag the index down to 24,500-24,000 in the coming weeks.

In case the index manages to bounce back from around 25,650, a relief rally to 26,500 is a possibility. But thereafter the index can resume the fall.



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

MOMENTUM GAINS

The dollar index has potential to see 100.70-101 in the short term

Overall, the bias is bearish to see a fall to 24,500-24,000. This can happen either from here itself or after a short-lived corrective bounce.

DOLLAR INDEX

The dollar index (100.10) has risen sharply breaking above the resistance at 99.55. The outlook is bullish. The region between 99.55 and 99.45 will now act as a good support. A fall below 99.45 is needed to bring the index under pressure. But that looks less likely.

Dollar index can rise to 100.70-101 in the short term. The region between 101 and 101.30 will be a very crucial resistance zone from a long-term perspective. A sustained rise above 101.30 can see the dollar index rallying to 105 this year.

TREASURY YIELD

The 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.53 per cent) has risen back well from the low of 4.42 per cent last week. Important resistance to watch now is at 4.6 per cent. A decisive break above this resistance can take the 10Yr Yield higher to 4.8 per cent in the coming weeks. It will also keep the doors open to see 5 per cent on the upside eventually over the long term.

Failure to rise above 4.6 per cent and a subsequent fall below 4.5 per cent will bring back the chances of seeing 4.4-4.35 per cent on the downside.

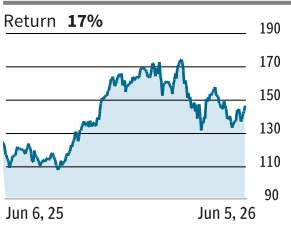
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

What is the outlook for Canara Bank? Is this a good time to enter this stock?

V Natarajan

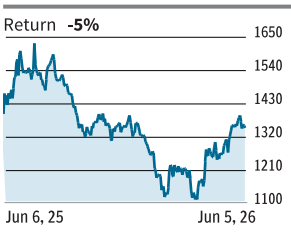


Canara Bank (₹136): The recent fall from the high of ₹163 in February is getting support above ₹120. The 50 per cent Fibonacci retracement support is also poised around this level. A double-bottom pattern could get formed. All

these factors leave the bias positive. A decisive break above ₹150 will boost the momentum and will indicate the resumption of the broader uptrend. Canara Bank share price can rise to ₹200 over the medium term. Buy now and accumulate at ₹126. Keep the stop-loss at ₹112. Move the stop-loss up to ₹140 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹165. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹155 and ₹170 when the price touches ₹165 and ₹185, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹200.

I would like to buy Rainbow Children's Medicare shares. Please suggest a good entry level.

T Srikrishna, Bengaluru

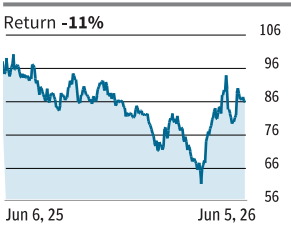


Rainbow Children's Medicare (₹1,347): The bounce from the low of ₹1,009 made in March looks strong. However, there is no confirmation of a bullish trend reversal yet. For that, the stock has to breach ₹1,550. Only

then the upside will open up for a rise to ₹2,000-₹2,100. It is better to buy the stock after the breakout above ₹1,550. Keep a stop-loss at ₹1,340. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹1,660 when the price goes up to ₹1,740. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,780 and ₹1,885 when the share price touches ₹1,845 and ₹1,930, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹2,040. If you can take risk, then buy now and accumulate at ₹1,160. Keep the stop-loss at ₹940 for the same target of ₹2,040.

I bought Shriram Properties shares at ₹139. Shall I continue to hold or sell?

Vijayan Kuttadian, Kannur

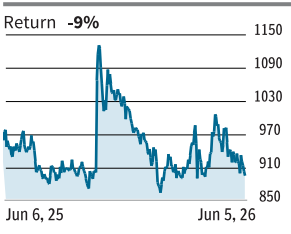


Shriram Properties (₹88): The stock is oscillating in a wide range and is now moving up from the lower end. The price action on the chart indicates that the stock can breach ₹100. This will open the doors for a

fresh rally to ₹180 in the coming months. Accumulate at current levels and also at ₹74 if a fall happens. Keep the stop-loss at ₹53. Move the stop-loss up to ₹95 when the price goes up to ₹115. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹120 and ₹150 when the share price touches ₹140 and ₹165, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹180. Patience is key here.

I have Hatsun Agro Products shares. My average purchase price is ₹927. What is the outlook?

Shiek Peer A, Madurai



Hatsun Agro Products (₹896): The stock has been struggling to get a sustained rise above ₹1,000 for more than a year now. Support is in the ₹800-₹700 region. A sustained rise above ₹1,000 is needed to take the share price higher

towards ₹1,350. This looks like it can take a long time based on the recent price action on the chart. If you have the patience, keep the stop-loss at ₹680 and hold the stock. Buy more on dips ₹860. Move the stop-loss up to ₹980 when the price goes up to ₹1,150. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,170 and ₹1,240 when the price touches ₹1,210 and ₹1,270. Exit the stock at ₹1,330. In case you don't want to wait, then exit the stock now with minimal loss.

Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1 Tata Technologies

2 Ola Electric Mobility

3 Sheela Foam

4 Federal Bank

5 Fortis Healthcare

Last week's prize winner
Kanikraj

Last week's winning stock
ACME Solar Holdings

Closing price (May 29)
₹310.55

Closing price (June 5)
₹356.25

Return:
14.72 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.7 and 0.8 per cent respectively last week. BSE Consumer Durables gained the most by 1.7 per cent, followed by BSE Bankex 0.6 per cent and BSE Healthcare 0.2 per cent. BSE Power and BSE Realty declined by 3 and 2 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Tech
P/E	20.2	20.1	33.2	13.9	56.4	64.7	32.7	42.0	19.9	19.4	8.3	37.1	11.1	36.5	20.3
P/BV	3.1	4.0	6.4	2.2	15.8	16.1	7.4	7.2	5.9	3.9	1.6	5.0	2.3	4.8	7.5
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.1	1.2	1.0	0.4	0.5	0.9	0.5	2.3	0.3	2.9	1.0	2.4	0.4	1.8
Weekly Return (%)	-0.8 ▼	-0.7 ▼	-0.6 ▼	0.6 ▲	-1.0 ▼	1.7 ▲	-1.8 ▼	0.2 ▲	0.2 ▲	-1.3 ▼	-0.7 ▼	-3.0 ▼	-0.6 ▼	-2.0 ▼	-0.2 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-2.8 ▼	-3.6 ▼	-0.2 ▼	0.1 ▲	2.0 ▲	-0.4 ▼	-6.1 ▼	3.5 ▲	-0.2 ▼	1.6 ▲	-3.8 ▼	-1.5 ▼	-5.0 ▼	-3.2 ▼	0.9 ▲
Annual Return (%)	-5.6 ▼	-8.8 ▼	10.2 ▲	-2.1 ▼	12.7 ▲	1.7 ▲	-12.3 ▼	9.0 ▲	-23.1 ▼	40.4 ▲	-1.2 ▼	20.2 ▲	5.2 ▲	-22.2 ▼	-16.7 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 ONE [1]	1074.2	29.9	35.9	4.4	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	-3.0	14.3	0.0	12730.0	906.2
3M India [1]	32026.0	542.7	59.0	16.8	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	29.3	-2.2	39.8	0.0	38300.0	28300.0
A B B [2]	7163.7	71.9	99.7	19.4	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	-0.9	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	101.9	1.7	59.6	8.8	202603	11.9	57.7	7.2	29.4	0.7	11.7	2.3	176.1	87.7
A B Real Estate [1]	1237.8	-27.0	3.7	202603	-79.1	-87.4	-66.4	-605.4	-0.1	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [1]	469.5	25.4	18.5	2.7	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	-1.5	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2
Aarti Industries [5]	458.2	11.4	40.3	2.8	202603	13.1	42.7	14.1	25.2	-3.5	11.2	0.7	529.2	338.2
AARTIS Financials	1297.8	61.0	21.0	2.7	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-3.8	9.9	3.2	1552.0	915.0
Abbot India	2601.7	730.4	35.6	11.6	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	-3.2	45.0	0.0	9392.1	6251.6
ACC [1]	1330.5	112.4	11.8	1.2	202603	16.9	-62.9	17.3	-9.0	-4.9	11.2	0.0	2027.8	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	356.3	8.3	42.9	4.3	202603	12.5	0.9	44.0	87.6	14.7	7.4	2.8	360.0	195.7
Adani Consl.Ety. [2]	898.6	34.9	25.8	5.3	202603	7.1	16.5	-1.4	1.4	4.0	14.2	0.0	1275.0	746.1
Adani Energy Sol [1]	1579.9	19.0	83.1	7.5	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	4.4	9.5	1.9	1591.7	745.5
Adani Green [1]	3047.9	16.7	182.3	5.0	202603	20.3	-124.0	26.0	-48.0	3.7	5.6	1.5	3580.7	1753.5
Adani Green [1]	1252.1	11.2	136.0	13.0	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.5	3.4	8.0	5.7	1532.7	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1823.1	56.3	32.4	4.4	202603	26.5	11.6	27.1	14.9	1.0	13.8	0.7	1843.1	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	232.6	6.7	34.9	7.2	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-4.5	16.6	0.8	254.2	105.7
Adani Total Gas [1]	762.3	6.0	127.8	17.2	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	-1.3	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Adani [2]	1048.5	33.8	31.0	7.5	202603	0.9	-18.0	9.5	-0.8	-35.5	0.0	112.28	708.0	
Aditya Birla Fns. [1]	60.1	-6.1	1.3	202603	15.7	-184.0	11.2	-4.9	-6.9	0.0	1.3	9.9	9.4	6.6
Aditya Birla Cap [1]	357.6	14.5	24.6	2.7	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	-1.7	9.5	4.4	375.9	222.5
Aegis Logistics [1]	771.0	25.6	30.1	4.5	202603	52.2	45.7	23.2	35.4	2.9	14.5	0.9	943.9	578.0
Aegis Vopak Term [1]	189.9	2.3	83.3	4.9	202603	22.2	17.6	25.8	75.0	-3.2	7.0	2.5	320.0	158.8
Aether Industri. [1]	113.5	1.7	66.8	6.2	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	1.8	4.7	0.1	1274.2	325.2
Alicons Infrastr. [1]	319.0	8.5	37.6	2.2	202603	-18.9	-179.7	-48	-36.0	-4.0	14.4	0.6	47.1	265.9
Affle 3i [2]	1474.0	32.3	45.6	5.7	202603	20.3	16.0	19.5	19.1	0.4	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.9
Alia Engineering [2]	4631.2	136.4	34.0	5.4	202603	9.6	37.9	0.1	19.9	0.3	19.1	0.1	4780.0	3000.6
Alkerm Pharma [2]	2297.6	34.5	35.2	8.2	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	25.4	-4.2	2.0	1.1	3310.2	235.0
Alkem Pharma [2]	73.70	37.0	19.9	2.6	202603	14.4	40.8	10.1	26.9	0.3	13.1	0.2	1107.8	635.3
Alkem Lab [2]	5251.3	180.8	26.0	4.5	202603	14.6	3.6	13.5	11.4	-4.5	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8
Alkyl Amines [2]	177.54	35.2	50.4	5.9	202603	0.2	-1.4	-2.3	-3.3	7.4	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1032.7
Allied Blenders [2]	179.9	4.2	37.4	9.8	202603	9.4	-48.1	11.4	18.2	3.4	21.0	0.9	720.0	382.7
Allo Industries [1]	12.5	-1.6	-4.2	-202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	-2.7	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.1	1.1
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	850.3	38.5	22.1	1.9	202603	15.5	11.6	7.5	-18.9	-4.1	15.6	0.0	1058.1	671.5
Amber Enterp. [1]	7829.7	17.1	371.1	6.3	202603	10.5	-26.8	22.2	17.3	2.8	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0
Amruba Cements [2]	417.4	20.0	20.8	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	-6.8	6.7	0.0	625.0	394.0
Amruba Ceram. Ws. [1]	215.5	2.8	36.8	24.7	202603	29.4	40.2	19.6	20.4	-1.7	96.8	0.1	199.7	97.50
Anant Raj [2]	570.0	15.4	37.0	3.5	202603	19.6	23.6	21.9	30.4	10.7	10.9	0.1	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	332.9	10.0	33.2	5.0	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-1.3	14.8	1.0	351.0	208.9
Apac Inds. [1]	1386.7	293.1	55.7	10.3	202603	26.6	3.7	23.3	21.8	5.9	32.6	0.1	1418.9	680.0
Apac Apollo Tubes [2]	40.2	1.2	34.0	28.2	202603	17.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2
Apollo Hospitals [5]	843.6	136.0	61.0	12.6	202603	18.1	35.9	15.8	35.3	1.5	17.5	0.6	849.3	668.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	396.2	33.6	11.8	1.5	202603	14.2	254.7	9.0	72.5	0.4	10.9	0.3	540.3	365.4
Apus Value Hou. [2]	265.4	18.8	14.1	2.6	202603	18.7	26.0	25.2	25.5	2.2	15.1	1.5	349.3	193.5
Arora Glass Inds [1]	900.6	19.5	38.7	9.5	202603	15.5	43.2	7.8	1.7	-0.4	13.1	0.9	1072.6	13.4
Ashtek Leyland [1]	145.4	6.4	22.9	6.0	202603	17.1	9.0	15.9	20.9	-6.5	14.9	4.3	215.4	115.0
Asian Paints [1]	2685.2	46.3	58.0	12.1	202603	10.8	43.6	5.1	13.2	0.5	24.4	0.1	2855.5	2116.0
Aster DM Health. [1]	753.6	7.8	96.8	9.2	202603	18.2	39.7	12.2	17.6	3.5	11.6	0.5	116.5	67.5
Astral [1]	151.4	2.4	70.1	11.2	202603	16.8	10.2	10.8	12.8	-0.4	12.7	0.1	120.0	10.8
Astrazeneca Phar [2]	659.6	76.6	112.3	24.6	202603	20.4	-26.6	32.6	0.6	-0.8	32.9	0.0	10653.1	7630.0
Ather Energy [1]	1033.4	-13.4	15.4	202603	73.7	-142.8	36.8	36.9	7.3	0.0	1.1	1046.7	306.1	
Atul [1]	667.3	230.3	29.0	3.2	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	-2.4	12.8	0.0	739.0	556.0
AU Small Finance [1]	142.2	1.2	12.0	10.0	202603	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	146.2	61.1	23.9	2.2	202603	4.4	2.0	6.4	1.8	2.2	14.2	0.2	1550.0	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	46.22	22.7	20.3	2.7	202603	-78.6	-96.6	-43.0	-54.5	-3.1	29.7	0.1	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super. [1]	4144.2	45.5	91.0	11.1	202603	18.9	19.2	15.9	9.7	2.0	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.3
Avenue Capital. [1]	119.5	10.2	12.1	1.4	202603	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4
Axis Bank [2]	1273.2	84.8	15.0	1.9	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	-1.1	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1001.7

B HELL [2]	387.0	4.6	84.2	5.2	202603	36.9	155.8	19.2	199.7	-7.1	3.2	0.4	424.9	205.2
B PCL [1]	255.1	60.3	4.9	1.3	202603	6.7	26.1	3.4	92.1	-0.8	15.7	0.7	39.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto [1]	10340.3	385.4	26.8	7.4	202603	40.2	101.6	22.6	47.1	-1.1	28.1	0.2	10385.0	7879.5
Bajaj Finance [1]	889.2	30.8	28.8	4.9	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	-1.7	11.4	0.3	1125.0	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	111.1	12.9	27.1	3.5	202603	5.0	13.2	13.4	14.4	-4.6	12.4	0.8	2194.7	884.8
Bajaj Holdings [1]	10201.6	736.5	13.9	1.6	202603	-58.3	49.2	56.3	25.7	-1.4	11.5	0.0	10487.2	8597.8
Bajaj Housing [1]	84.2	3.1	27.3	3.1	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-1.0	9.5	4.7	128.4	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2142.7	64.3	33.3	3.8	202603	6.6	-18.7	3.6	-24.9	-3.9	17.9	0.3	2026.0	2016.0
Balrampur Chim [1]	532.5	17.9	29.7	2.5	202603	6.7	-30.4	15.8	-13.4	-3.6	11.1	0.6	627.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank [1]	205.9	7.6	27.1	1.3	202603	-0.1	68.0	-1.2	-55.4	-1.1	0.0	0.0	212.6	13.4
Bank of Baroda [2]	263.7	38.4	6.9	0.8	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	-1.8	0.0	0.0	325.6	230.6
Bank of India [1]	141.5	23.5	6.0	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	1.1	0.0	0.0	178.5	19.0
Bank of Maha [1]	79.1	9.1	8.7	1.9	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	-0.2	0.0	0.0	85.9	51.7
BASF India [1]	3415.9	94.0	36.4	3.7	202603	4.8	20.1	-0.4	-12.4	-0.1	17.9	0.1	5251.0	290.6
Bata India [1]	665.0	12.8	51.8	5.4	202603	5.0	-58.6	0.8	-29.1	-0.7	14.6	0.9	1287.9	605.9
Baychem Corp [1]	4345.9	153.4	28.3	6.6	202603	5.2	13.1	3.7	21.3	-3.8	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.9
Bayer CropSci. [1]	1742.4	17.0	102.7	5.0	202603	8.6	37.5	8.2	-51.7	1.4	11.7	0.1	2437.4	136.1
Bayer Plaints [1]	490.2	10.0	49.0	8.3	202603	6.1	17.3	2.9	-1.2	-2.1	24.8	0.1	604.6	39.1
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1207.3	11.5	105.3	10.4	202603	-72.9	-58.5	-27.3	-23.5	0.2	10.2	0.0	2013.6	1090.1
Bharat Electron [1]	408.1	8.3	49.2	12.4	202603	11.7	4.6	16.2	13.9	-0.7	36.9	0.0	473.3	361.1
Bharti Airtel [1]	1799.0	48.2	37.2	7.4	202603	15.7	-12.0	12.0	10.1	-1.7	14.3	0.2	2127.4	1743.5
Bharti Hexacom [1]	1749.8	35.1	42.1	10.3	202603	5.4	-1.1	9.4	35.6	-1.1	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1438.1
Bikaji Foods [1]	654.4	10.4	62.8	10.2	202603	19.0	26.1	15.1	30.7	0.7	18.4	0.2	820.9	591.9
Birla Com [1]	412.1	8.8	107.9	2.0	202603	4.9	-61.6	11.5	-35.4	-3.8	10.0	0.0	404.0	327.7
Birla Com [1]	964.8	72.9	13.2	1.2	202603	0.8	-3.6	4.8	72.9	-3.3	7.2	0.6	1532.7	73.5
Birlsoft Ltd [2]	327.9	19.4	16.9	2.2	202603	2.4	44.1	-1.2	4.9	2.4	20.8	0.0	473.8	30.6
BLU Internet [1]	261.2	16.7	15.7	4.4	202603	17.6	31.6	36.7	35.1	0.0	39.0	0.1	415.0	218.8
Blue Bird [1]	127.7	1.2	10.0	1.2	202603	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2
Blue Jet Health [2]	465.1	14.3	32.6	5.9	202603	-31.1	-41.6	-8.0	-18.8	3.7	40.4	0.0	1028.2	325.5
Blue Star [2]	1582.8	27.0	58.7	9.5	202603	1.3	10.4	3.6	-4.7	-0.4	25.8	0.1	2050.0	1450.8
Bosch [1]	37242.5	789.4	47.2	7.4	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	1.6	20.5	0.4	41994.0	32850.5
Bosch [1]	1582.8	27.0	58.7	9.5	202603	1.3	10.4	3.6	-4.7	-0.4	25.8	0.1	2050.0	1450.8
Brigade Enterprise [1]	651.1	26.8	24.3	2.3	202603	-0.2	-42.1	12.3	-4.4	-0.1	13.3	1.2	1332.0	61.5
Britannia Inds [1]	5119.7	105.2	48.7	24.2	202603	7.1	21.1	7.5	15.3	-1.4	51.9	0.4	6337.0	5038.0

Add-on boost to employee health insurance plans

POLICY-WISE. Personal cover, riders and top-ups can help plug gaps in workplace health insurance scheme



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Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Employer-provided health insurance, commonly known as group health cover, is an important benefit that many organisations offer to safeguard employees during medical emergencies. It helps in reducing the financial burden of hospitalisation, treatments and other healthcare expenses.

While this type of coverage is valuable and often cost-effective, it may not always provide comprehensive protection. It is important to understand the gaps in coverage and explore ways to strengthen the basic group cover.

PERSONAL COVERS

At the outset, it must be understood that a personal cover is non-negotiable, even with an existing group cover. A personal health cover, or even better, a family health cover, addresses the two main sticking points in a group cover: Continuity and coverage.

As is evident, a group cover ceases the day the employee leaves the organisation. Relying on a group cover implies that health protection is exposed to

the volatility of employment, which is exactly the risk one aims to avoid with health insurance. A personal cover that is up to date on payments provides coverage even during phases of job volatility.

Coverage is also one of the least understood aspects of group covers. Group cover is, by design, aimed at covering basic and routine healthcare needs. Group coverage is thus limited in amount and is not designed to handle complex care such as oncology, higher-order cardiology, or kidney-related ailments, for instance. These are therapies for which physical recovery may be possible, but continued productive employment may remain uncertain and hence may not fall under the purview of group insurance.

COVERING THE ELDERLY

If the organisation is providing cover for the elderly, it is prudent to opt for the same, despite having personal cover for them. Group covers have one major advantage compared with personal covers: Less resistance at the time of claims.

Personal health insurance for the elderly is expensive and comes with a host of conditions. Waiting periods, for instance,

COVER SMART

- Personal cover protects beyond job changes
- Group cover has continuity, coverage limits
- Top-up plans help with large medical bills

This could be a PED, or pre-existing disease, waiting period of three years, or a slow-growing disease, such as cataract or knee replacement, with a waiting period of one year. Group covers can start protecting members from the first day, owing to the large number of people covered. Also, most covers for the elderly include a deductible, either to reduce the cost or as a non-negotiable feature. This is also avoided in group covers. Also, as an intangible benefit, companies employ TPAs, or third-party administrators, that liaise between the claimant and the insurance company.

The professional intermediary eases the claim experience compared with personal health insurance, where, at the time of claim, personal effort is required to process the claim at

the policyholder's end. This support can extend to unresolved claims, documentation, delays and partial approvals.

ADD-ONS AND RIDERS

Similarly, if certain add-ons or riders, like critical illness, consumables, or OPD covers, are available in a group insurance plan, or even a personal cover, they should be considered.

A critical illness rider gives you a lump-sum amount if you are diagnosed with a serious illness listed in the policy. Unlike regular health insurance, which pays only for medical expenses, this rider gives you money that you can use in any way you need. It can help you pay for treatment, manage daily expenses, or make up for lost income while you recover. This add-on can be especially useful for people who may have a higher risk of certain illnesses because of their family medical history.

A consumables add-on is a valuable feature that policyholders may consider. Consumables are disposable items used during treatment and are generally excluded from standard health insurance coverage. Consequently, these expenses are often borne by the policyholder despite claim approval. As they

can account for 8-10 per cent of a hospital bill, particularly in the post-Covid context, this add-on can help reduce out-of-pocket expenditure.

OPD consultation charges can be covered by OPD cover add-ons. An OPD cover of ₹10,000 or more per annum can enhance the use-case of a group cover for employees.

SUPER TOP-UP

In circumstances where an individual relies exclusively on employer-provided group health insurance, it is advisable to also consider a super top-up health insurance plan to enhance overall financial protection against high medical expenses.

Super top-up insurance can be purchased externally. These plans include a deductible limit, which is generally set at the base policy's sum insured limit. When the deductible limit, which is the group cover's limit, is breached, these plans can be utilised to cover the remaining expenses. A super top-up plan with a ₹3-lakh deductible and ₹25-lakh cover costs around ₹5,000-10,000 per annum, based on the insurer. This can be a low-cost way to enhance a group cover cost-effectively, in the absence of personal health cover.

Preserving wealth amid market volatility

FINANCIAL PLANNING. Read on to know how a 49-year-old professional builds his retirement corpus through SIPs

Sridevi V

Prithivi, 49, wanted to ensure he retires at 58. His experience in the recent market fall made him seek professional guidance.

Prithivi works in an IT services firm at Bangalore. His job is relatively secured, as he continuously upgrades his skills and works in a specific domain.

He has been investing in mutual funds since 2009. Most of his MF investments are through the systematic route. He is a disciplined investor and built a sleek portfolio with 12 schemes. He invests ₹1.8 lakh per month across eight schemes. The current portfolio value is ₹2.2 crore.

He experienced portfolio returns fluctuating from 18 per cent to the current 14.5 per cent in the last 24 months. He is comfortable with market volatility and is willing to participate during market corrections with his systematic investments to benefit from rupee cost averaging.

He is now looking at preserving his wealth prior to his retirement, and systematically lock in gains when the returns are relatively higher.

REVIEW, RECOMMENDATIONS:

It is important to understand his thought process which does

not indicate panic or low risk tolerance. His desire to lock in gains at higher valuations stems from his experience and evolving financial priorities, here it is his retirement. This can be addressed in two parts. One is identifying his retirement corpus, and the second part is addressing his emotional need of gradually shifting gains to fixed income nearing retirement.

Identifying his retirement corpus: Though there are mathematical calculations to get the corpus, there are many economic assumptions used in arriving at the corpus. Hence, in Prithivi's case, it was advised to work on the reverse.

If he continues to invest ₹1.8 lakh per month till 58, he will be accumulating ₹7.51 crore at 10 per cent expected return; ₹9.85 crore at 14 per cent expected return; and ₹12.99 crore at 18 per cent expected return in the next eight years. This kind of wealth will help him to withdraw Rs ₹1.23-2.12 lakh of retirement income at current cost till his life expectancy of 90 years.

It is a usual behaviour of most investors, to be more cautious while nearing retirement, and be concerned about major market corrections that could potentially affect the withdrawal. Hence it was suggested to work on a combination of fixed in-



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SAGE ADVICE

A sensible approach is to set an appropriate return expectation and an asset allocation at the time of retirement

come investments with safety of capital, towards a fixed withdrawal through interest payouts and a basket of equity mutual funds to address the inflation-adjusted expenses.

Shifting gains to fixed income: As the returns thus far had been in a range, it was ad-

vised to target 12 per cent returns to arrive at the corpus. As and when the returns at a scheme-level move substantially higher than this expected number of 12 per cent, the excess returns need to be moved to either debt or a balanced advantage fund depending on other scenarios like market valuations, future prospects of returns, time horizon available and so on. In Prithivi's case, he was also advised to keep a minimum 40 per cent in equity MF (and a maximum of 60 per cent) at the time of his retirement. Currently, his mutual fund port-

folio is at 90 per cent equity that drives him to think of ways to preserve the wealth to be generated and protect his corpus while nearing retirement.

It would be very difficult for anyone to exit at the "Right Time" to avoid market fall. But a sensible approach would be to set an appropriate return expectation and an asset allocation at the time of retirement. This would help one to focus on the right action items based on one's own rule book rather than just on market swings. It is suggested to work on an asset allocation of 70:30 in favour of equity in the next three-four years and slowly moving to 60 per cent in the subsequent two-three years would help him reduce the future uncertainty. Market valuations will be carefully considered while managing the asset allocation.

It should also be remembered that retirement is not a day when equity exposure should be moved to zero. There should be certainty of withdrawal from fixed income for the short term and there should be equity participation to address longevity and sufficiency of retirement income that tames inflation.

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Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	May 27
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.65	6.5	6.25	6	May 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.65	6.1	6	Jun 01
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Jun 05
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	May 29
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Jun 01
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	7.1	6.5	7.25	Jun 01
Federal Bank	6	6.8	6.75	6.4	Jun 03
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Jun 05
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	7.15	Apr 18
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jun 01
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.75	6.15	6.15	Apr 11
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	May 14
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	7.2	6.55	6.55	Apr 06
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	May 14
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	7.75	7.75	6	May 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	7.5	7.77	Jun 02
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.4	7.25	7.55	05-Jun

Data as on respective banks' website on 05 Jun 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

BharatPe's Credit-on-UPI solution

BharatPe has announced the launch of 'BharatPe Flex', a Credit-on-UPI solution powered by YES BANK. It is designed to enable customers to make everyday UPI payments with greater flexibility and control. BharatPe Flex users can continue making payments across existing UPI ecosystems while accessing the credit line integrated into the UPI experience.

Shriram General Insurance, Piramal Finance tie-up

Shriram General Insurance (SGI) has announced a strategic corporate agency partnership with Piramal Finance to improve access to insurance solutions, particularly across semi-urban and rural markets.

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RISL invites e-bids from the eligible bidders for the following:

NIB No./ Date/ Unique bid no.	Particulars	Estimated Cost	Start of sale / Last date
ML-258 / 05.06.2026 / RIS2627WS0B00026	Request for Proposal (RFP) Interior Works for Establishment of Control Room in CMO, Jaipur.	Rs. 2.70 Cr./ Rs. 5,40,000/-	10.06.2026 / 17.06.2026

Details can be seen on the websites <http://risl.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://doitc.rajasthan.gov.in>. Bids are to be submitted through <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>

Raj, Samwadi/C/26/4294 AEN (Civil), RISL

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Phone : +91-120-6102000/6102009 CIN: U40101UP2007PLC032835
NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST
Prayagraj Power Generation Company Limited invites expression of interest (EOI) from eligible vendors for **1 year contract for Fire Service for PPGCL Plant and Associates Areas** Thermal Power Plant at Prayagraj Power Generation Company Limited, Bara, Dist. Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, India.
Details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc. may be downloaded using the **URL- <https://www.ppgcl.co.in/tenders.php>** Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **13th June 2026**.

Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,792
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	10,838
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	12,033
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,173
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% issuance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	8,828
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,474
Reliance General	My HealthCare	Additional 30% discount on premium & fully customisable plan. Single pvt AC Room. ₹3.33 lakh NCB. Restoration of cover once a year.	7,326

Date: June 05, 2026. Source: www.policybazaar.com. NCB: No Claim Bonus

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)		Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: June 05, 2026

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bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	58.7	16542	1.4	0.5	-6.0	10.2	9.4	13.0	0.30
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	104.4	75650	1.1	0.7	-3.9	13.2	12.7	13.5	0.45
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	86.6	51690	3.5	2.8	-3.2	13.3	14.5	14.2	0.50
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1071.4	38121	1.5	1.0	-4.3	10.6	11.4	12.4	0.38
*****	JM Large Cap	146.3	422	2.8	1.3	-2.7	11.5	10.8	10.5	0.33
*****	Kotak Large Cap	542.7	10599	1.8	0.7	-3.9	10.9	10.1	11.9	0.33
*****	SBI Large Cap	90.5	53468	1.5	0.8	-1.0	10.3	10.6	11.7	0.35
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	494.8	28970	1.4	0.8	-4.8	10.6	10.5	11.5	0.34
***	Bandhan Large Cap	74.4	2007	1.8	0.8	-1.4	12.5	11.1	12.2	0.34
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	212.4	2579	1.7	0.7	-2.7	12.4	11.1	12.2	0.36
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	79.8	1439	2.1	0.7	-3.9	10.2	10.3	12.1	0.32
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	963.6	7236	1.5	1.0	-4.0	10.3	8.1	10.2	0.25
***	Invesco India Largecap	67.8	1722	1.8	0.7	-1.0	13.7	11.9	12.2	0.36
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	106.9	38239	1.3	0.5	-3.8	9.2	8.9	12.3	0.28
***	Tata Large Cap	488.2	2688	1.7	0.8	-1.1	11.1	10.7	11.5	0.34
***	UTI Large Cap	253.9	11853	1.9	1.1	-6.0	8.3	8.2	11.0	0.24
***	DSP Large Cap	441.7	7192	1.5	0.7	-5.9	12.3	10.3	11.0	0.35
***	HSBC Large Cap	451.4	1784	2.1	1.2	-2.1	10.5	9.5	11.5	0.28
**	LIC MF Large Cap	51.1	1352	3.6	2.4	-8.1	7.3	7.2	9.8	0.20
**	Union Largecap	22.4	439	2.1	1.3	-3.7	9.1	8.9	-	0.27
**	Axis Large Cap	56.6	30498	1.6	0.7	-5.2	8.4	6.5	11.3	0.17
*	Groww Largecap	41.3	128	2.7	1.4	-1.5	10.5	9.5	10.6	0.28
**	PGIM India Large Cap	317.8	544	2.5	0.9	-5.3	7.0	6.8	9.6	0.19
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.3	701	2.0	0.6	-6.8	9.3	8.5	-	0.26
-	Taurus Large Cap	151.7	51	2.1	1.9	-2.1	11.8	9.8	9.7	0.29

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	136.3	16672	1.4	0.4	3.7	20.9	17.1	15.6	0.55
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	330.4	28255	1.6	0.8	-0.9	15.9	15.4	14.3	0.50
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	983.8	29757	1.4	0.7	-0.5	17.0	17.0	15.4	0.61
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.0	15582	2.0	0.9	3.3	15.3	13.6	-	0.39
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	122.4	3249	1.9	0.7	5.0	18.4	15.8	15.8	0.44
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	625.3	38426	1.7	1.0	3.7	14.5	14.1	14.6	0.49
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	177.9	5964	1.8	1.0	1.1	18.1	15.1	13.9	0.52
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	88.2	468	2.1	1.0	1.3	14.6	12.5	12.4	0.39
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	240.2	2567	1.4	0.5	-5.7	12.6	11.4	14.7	0.36
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	599.0	17331	1.4	0.5	-2.0	16.3	12.9	14.6	0.42
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	86.9	4531	1.9	0.5	0.7	15.2	13.4	14.3	0.42
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	100.9	9761	1.5	0.5	3.1	22.1	16.8	15.8	0.47
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	334.8	30251	1.6	0.6	-0.1	14.8	14.0	15.0	0.44
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	149.3	42338	1.3	0.5	1.6	14.2	11.8	16.5	0.36
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1441.1	7081	1.8	1.1	0.2	17.3	15.0	12.9	0.48
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	180.7	3399	1.7	1.1	-4.1	13.0	10.5	11.2	0.35
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	36.6	2958	3.5	2.3	-5.4	14.2	12.0	14.0	0.38
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	84.3	6575	1.8	0.8	1.4	13.4	12.8	14.0	0.38
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	480.7	7802	1.5	0.6	-7.6	8.1	10.2	12.3	0.32
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	894.9	5648	1.6	0.9	0.1	12.3	8.9	11.4	0.23
*	Navi Large & Midcap	34.9	300	2.1	0.5	-0.8	10.0	11.1	12.6	0.33
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.8	4877	3.1	2.0	9.9	19.2	15.4	-	0.39

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1927.5	100479	1.3	0.7	-0.8	16.8	16.8	15.7	0.61
*****	JM Flexicap	93.3	5041	2.6	1.4	-3.3	16.0	15.7	16.1	0.48
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.4	140950	1.1	0.5	-1.8	14.3	14.5	16.8	0.55
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.2	3320	1.9	0.5	0.0	14.6	13.1	14.3	0.41
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1535.9	19049	1.4	0.8	-5.9	13.8	13.1	12.9	0.41
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	34.8	5793	1.9	0.6	-2.1	9.5	8.7	13.4	0.26
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.2	2294	1.7	0.8	-2.6	11.7	11.2	12.6	0.35
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1831.4	25632	1.4	0.7	3.4	15.7	12.3	14.0	0.38
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	202.1	7285	1.5	0.9	-1.3	12.6	11.0	10.7	0.34
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	325.2	13083	1.5	0.5	-2.8	11.4	10.4	13.7	0.33
***	DSP Flexi Cap	98.4	11769	1.5	0.6	-3.4	12.8	10.5	13.9	0.31
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	220.3	5405	2.3	1.5	1.8	17.1	13.9	12.8	0.39
***	Kotak Flexicap	82.6	54839	1.4	0.6	-2.2	13.1	11.5	13.4	0.36
***	SBI Flexicap	104.4	22403	2.3	1.5	-1.3	8.9	8.9	11.6	0.28
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.0	3633	1.6	0.6	-4.0	11.8	10.0	-	0.33
***	Axis Flexi Cap	26.0	12546	1.7	0.6	-1.2	12.4	9.4	-	0.25
***	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	57.1	12770	1.9	1.1	-5.0	18.0	11.7	12.3	0.31
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.5	260	2.1	0.5	4.9	10.9	10.9	-	0.33
**	UTI Flexi Cap	295.5	22248	1.6	1.0	-7.7	7.0	5.5	11.1	0.13
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	96.3	973	3.5	2.4	3.6	10.8	9.8	9.9	0.28
**	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.1	128	3.3	1.7	-3.6	8.1	7.8	-	0.19
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	217.0	344	2.1	2.0	-3.3	11.6	9.9	9.5	0.29
-	Quant Flexi Cap	106.8	6594	1.8	0.7	9.9	18.9	16.8	19.7	0.46

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	283.8	3219	1.7	0.8	0.7	15.8	14.9	14.1	0.43
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	827.9	16997	1.4	0.8	5.2	18.6	15.9	14.9	0.54
-	Invesco India Multicap	121.9	3995	1.6	0.6	-7.0	13.6	11.7	13.2	0.34
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.6	6439	1.6	0.4	5.9	18.6	15.9	-	0.46
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	293.1	52634	1.6	0.9	-1.4	17.2	19.0	15.6	0.62
-	Quant Multi Cap	640.9	7466	1.8	0.7	2.0	12.7	12.4	17.3	0.31
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	363.8	2807	2.0	0.9	-2.5	13.7	13.0	14.4	0.41

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	104.2	15911	1.8	0.6	4.5	22.7	19.2	18.8	0.56
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	199.0	94745	1.3	0.7	4.6	21.2	19.7	17.8	0.64
*****	Quant Mid Cap	217.4	7905	1.8	0.7	-1.2	16.7	16.4	16.8	0.46
*****	Invesco India Midcap	183.2	11767	1.5	0.5	5.8	24.1	19.6	18.2	0.54
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	35.3	4688	1.6	0.4	7.9	22.5	18.5	-	0.53
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	91.1	35735	1.6	0.8	-9.3	17.2	21.1	16.3	0.57
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4330.5	45820	1.5	0.8	5.6	22.6	20.2	18.5	0.62
*****	Axis Midcap	115.5	32276	1.6	0.5	3.2	17.1	14.4	16.8	0.43
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	107.2	2389	1.7	0.5	7.5	19.7	16.0	15.5	0.50
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	332.0	7557	1.5	0.9	12.3	24.7	18.5	17.4	0.58
***	Kotak Midcap	139.2	63539	1.4	0.4	5.7	19.9	17.3	17.5	0.52
***	PGIM India Midcap	62.7	10738	2.0	0.8	-1.4	11.6	12.1	15.5	0.37
***	SBI Midcap	232.2	23247	1.6	0.9	-0.9	13.0	14.9	13.7	0.48
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1426.4	13378	1.7	0.9	4.7	22.0	18.3	15.0	0.55
***	Tata Mid Cap	440.7	5604	1.6	0.6	4.9	17.7	15.9	16.1	0.49
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	804.2	6290	1.6	0.9	3.7	18.2	15.8	13.8	0.47
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2662.6	12102	1.5	0.9	-2.4	17.7	14.4	14.2	0.42
**	Taurus Mid Cap	115.9	123	2.1	1.7	-4.5	11.8	11.5	14.6	0.32
**	UTI Mid Cap	297.0	11871	1.7	0.9	-0.8	14.1	13.2	13.9	0.39
**	DSP Midcap	148.1	19459	1.4	0.6	2.9	17.8	12.0	14.6	0.36
**	HSBC Midcap	493.2	13387	3.6	2.5	16.4	26.5	18.8	17.6	0.49
*	LIC MF Midcap	24.3	347	2.4	1.3	0.4	18.1	13.8	-	0.38

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	172.9	72673	1.4	0.7	2.9	18.4	20.2	20.9	0.55
*****	Quant Small Cap	269.0	30374	1.6	0.7	6.4	20.2	20.1	19.4	0.48

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

*****	AXIS Small Cap	106.8	27364	1.7	0.7	1.3	15.5	16.4	18.1	0.50
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	51.6	2168	1.7	0.5	11.3	21.4	19.2	-	0.46
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	43.6	11038	1.5	0.4	6.0	22.5	19.8	-	0.52
***	DSP Small Cap	208.2	17906	1.4	0.6	5.6	19.0	17.9	16.5	0.48
***	HDFC Small Cap	133.3	38168	1.5	0.7	-2.6	14.0	16.3	17.4	0.46
***	ICICI Pru Smallcap	85.5	8741	1.5	0.7	-0.7	13.1	15.2	16.1	0.50
***	Kotak Small Cap	255.1	17416	1.7	0.6	-2.4	13.5	13.4	16.5	0.38
***	Sundaram Small Cap	275.1	3563	1.9	0.9	7.8	18.7	17.3	14.8	0.46
***	Tata Small Cap	36.1	11330	1.5	0.4	-8.4	11.5	15.0	-	0.40
***	Union Small Cap	53.7	1980	1.8	0.8	13.6	19.1	17.4	16.2	0.45
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	169.9	13850	1.5	0.8	-1.8	16.2	17.7	15.0	0.47
**	HSBC Small Cap	82.1	16394	1.8	0.7	1.0	16.1	18.1	18.5	0.45
**	SBI Small Cap	169.0	37141	1.6	0.9	-0.2	12.5	13.4	17.9	0.40
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	91.3	5253	1.6	0.8	7.0	16.9	13.5	13.0	0.35
*	LIC MF Small Cap	31.6	660	2.8	1.5	6.0	17.2	17.5	-	0.44
	- Canara Robeco Small Cap	38.2	13276	1.5	0.5	-0.6	13.8	15.9	-	0.46
	- Edelweiss Small Cap	44.3	5952	2.1	0.8	2.5	17.1	17.1	-	0.49

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %ann	3 Month %ann	6 Month %ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2121.6	748	0.4	0.2	5.7	6.4	6.1	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	444.8	47520	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Axis Liquid	3075.1	56168	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.8	6.4	6.2	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3332.4	17286	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3180.7	1720	0.1	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.4	6.2	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3172.7	11380	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.6	6.3	6.1	0.20
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3323.6	7521	0.1	0.1	6.1	6.8	6.4	6.1	-
- DSP Liquidity	3941.9	22480	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.7	6.4	6.2	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3532.1	15222	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.8	6.4	6.2	-
- Groww Liquid	2669.6	262	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- HDFC Liquid	5415.5	67998	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
- HSBC Liquid	2751.6	16117	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	408.5	58096	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3794.1	14989	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- ITI Liquid	1435.4	49	0.2	0.2	5.7	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	75.2	2147	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.5	6.2	6.0	-
- Kotak Liquid	5577.3	40018	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4990.0	16015	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.8	6.3	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1796.5	1088	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2893.0	11182	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.1	0.40
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.5	937	0.4	0.2	5.5	6.0	5.8	5.7	-
- Navi Liquid	29.9	76	0.2	0.2	5.5	5.8	5.6	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6735.9	31752	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1530.6	5524	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.3	6.0	-
- PGIM India Liquid	359.4	612	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
- Quant Liquid	43.5	1247	0.6	0.3	5.2	5.6	5.7	5.7	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.8	530	0.3	0.2	5.4	5.8	5.7	5.6	-
- SBI Liquid	4313.1	79363	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2431.9	7657	0.4	0.1	5.9	6.6	6.2	6.0	-
- Tata Liquid	4347.5	30449	0.3	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2656.4	8782	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- UTI Liquid	4530.5	33248	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.8	6.4	6.2	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1483.1	608	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.6	6.2	6.0	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1457.4	9420	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1433.5	11863	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1438.2	813	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1378.8	143	0.1	0.1	7.1	5.9	5.5	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1421.4	1255	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1401.7	419	0.7	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1447.5	2116	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1401.0	192	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1413.2	1120	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1391.2	212	0.3	0.2	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	3987.3	10587	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1410.4	4681	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1455.7	13075	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1368.4	289	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1366.1	14	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1371.1	310	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1440.6	7846	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1397.6	1212	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1397.3	84	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1385.7	2025	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	145.0	7463	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1395.0	63	0.2	0.2	5.0	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4360.1	27025	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1433.5	1483	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1423.4	3895	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Union Overnight	1420.8	705	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3679.7	4259	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.9	25679	0.9	0.3	3.8	4.6	5.5	5.7	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.7	9718	2.5	1.8	3.7	4.7	5.5	5.6	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.1	7895	0.9	0.3	3.6	4.5	5.2	5.4	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.5	45	0.9	0.4	3.5	4.5	5.2	5.4	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.9	1255	0.9	0.3	3.8	4.4	5.1	5.4	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.7	6512	0.9	0.3	3.7	4.7	5.4	5.6	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.4	14717	3.3	2.7	4.2	4.9	5.5	5.7	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.3	24439	0.8	0.4	4.3	4.9	5.7	5.8	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.0	2532	2.3	1.7	3.9	5.0	5.6	5.7	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.1	32299	0.8	0.3	3.7	4.8	5.6	5.7	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.6	27321	0.9	0.3	4.5	4.9	5.7	5.9	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.6	88	0.9	0.3	3.4	4.7	5.7	5.8	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.2	367	1.5	0.8	4.0	4.4	5.3	5.4	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.5	69951	1.0	0.4	4.1	5.0	5.7	5.8	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	244	0.9	0.3	4.2	5.0	5.5	5.6	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	112	1.0	0.3	3.0	4.1	5.0	5.1	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.7	3461	0.8	0.1	4.2	4.6	5.5	5.6	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.9	16332	2.8	2.1	4.1	4.8	5.5	5.7	0.80
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.3	97	1.0	0.4	5.3	5.1	5.5	5.3	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.6	42847	2.3	1.8	4.3	5.0	5.6	5.8	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.2	442	1.0	0.3	4.4	5.2	5.8	5.7	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.1	21824	0.9	0.3	3.9	4.9	5.7	5.7	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.7	239	0.9	0.3	3.6	4.7	5.3	5.5	-
- UTI Arbitrage	36.9	10991	4.4	3.9	3.8	4.8	5.6	5.8	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	579.5	19611	0.5	0.3	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.3	10.92
***** Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1629.3	775	0.4	0.3	6.0	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4250.3	10938	1.1	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.7	6.7	19.13
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.1	4440	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.3	16002	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.8	6.1	9.63
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1382.6	1715	0.4	0.2	6.1	7.0	7.1	6.2	5.98
***** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4460.9	3997	1.0	0.4	5.6	6.5	6.6	6.4	8.59
***** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.5	6168	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.4	6.5	5.6	10.59
***** DSP Ultra Short	3582.4	4167	0.9	0.3	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.7	7.24
***** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.0	16658	0.7	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.8	6.0	5.31
***** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1430.1	3525	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
***** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2842.6	1197	0.7	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.8	4.42
***** Kotak Savings	45.2	16186	0.8	0.4	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.9	5.79
***** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1451.4	213	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.8	5.9	4.69
***** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6303.3	11861	0.6	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	8.98
***** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1430.6	560	1.1	0.6	5.4	6.3	6.4	5.6	-
***** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3327.0	140	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.3	5.6	7.86
***** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1388.8	371	1.4	0.2	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.5	1.46
***** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.8	175	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.2	6.3	5.6	2.86
***** Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	544	1.0	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.5	5.7	10.03
***** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3995.3	528	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.3	6.4	5.5	-
***** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	380	1.2	0.2	5.0	5.5	5.6	4.9	-
***** Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2808.3	2331	1.4	0.2	4.9	5.8	5.9	5.1	1.33

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	574.6	25885	0.5	0.4	5.9	7.2	7.4	6.5	7.01
***** UTI Low Duration	3744.2	3151	0.4	0.3	5.8	7.1	7.1	7.3	6.97
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3263.3	5803	0.7	0.4	5.7	7.0	7.0	6.2	8.24
***** DSP Low Duration	20.8	5108	0.5	0.3	5.3	6.7	6.8	5.9	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	60.7	20218	1.1	0.5	5.4	6.7	6.8	6.0	14.47
***** HSBC Low Duration	30.2	1012	0.9	0.4	5.6	7.5	7.4	6.2	10.14

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
***** Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	688.8	13011	1.0	0.4	5.2	6.5	6.5	5.8	9.81	
***** Bandhan Low Duration	40.6	5811	0.6	0.3	5.4	6.7	6.8	5.9	-	
***** Canara Robeco Savings	44.4	1099	0.4	0.2	5.6	6.8	6.8	5.9	-	
***** Invesco India Low Duration	3982.4	1849	0.5	0.3	5.5	6.8	6.9	5.9	5.23	
***** JM Low Duration	39.0	227	0.9	0.4	5.4	6.7	6.7	5.8	3.29	
***** Nippon Ind Low Duration	3939.8	9359	1.0	0.4	5.5	6.8	6.8	5.9	8.64	
***** SBI Low Duration	3665.4	13167	0.9	0.4	5.1	6.5	6.6	5.8	4.01	
***** Tata Treasury Advantage	4140.0	2755	0.5	0.2	5.6	6.8	6.8	6.0	3.80	
***** Kotak Low Duration	3509.3	13370	1.2	0.4	5.2	6.6	6.6	5.8	11.98	
***** Mahi Manu Low Duration	1717.7	550	0.9	0.3	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.6	13.80	
***** Mirae Asset Low Duration	2373.2	2176	0.7	0.2	5.3	6.6	6.7	5.7	5.27	
***** Sundaram Low Duration	3623.6	364	1.1	0.4	5.0	6.4	6.5	5.7	2.66	
***** Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.1	293	0.9	0.2	5.3	6.5	6.5	5.6	1.71	
***** LIC MF Low Duration	41.6	1608	0.5	0.3	5.3	6.5	6.5	5.7	6.40	

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

Monsoon advances up west coast even as signs of El Nino strengthen

WET SPELL. Met Department says conditions favourable for the rains to cover much of the country in 2-3 days

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon advanced further along the west coast and into the interior peninsula on Saturday, covering the whole of Goa and extending across parts of Karnataka, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh, while spreading over most of Tamil Nadu and into Mizoram and Manipur in the North-East.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said the monsoon’s northern limit passed through Devgad in Maharashtra; Koppal in Karnataka; Anantapuramu in Andhra Pradesh; Chennai; and Aizawl on Saturday afternoon.

Conditions remain fa-

vourable for the monsoon to advance further into Maharashtra, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, and Telangana, the remaining areas of Tamil Nadu, and the rest of the north-eastern States over the next two-three days.

Satellite imagery on Saturday evening showed extensive rain-bearing cloud bands over parts of Karnataka including Hubballi, Belagavi, and Kalaburagi; Kolhapur and Ratnagiri in Maharashtra; Hyderabad, Kakinada, Visakhapatnam and Komarada in Andhra Pradesh; Kalimela and large parts of Odisha; Jagdalpur in Chhattisgarh as well large parts of West Bengal and the southern parts of north-eastern States.

The IMD indicated that



RAIN IMMINENT. Intense clouds cover Maharashtra, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha and West Bengal as the monsoon extended across these States on Saturday

a fresh western disturbance expected around June 11 could dip south into the north-east Arabian Sea off the Konkan-Mumbai coast and emerge with a cyclonic circulation.

The system may trigger thunderstorms over Mumbai and adjoining south Gujarat for several days.

surface temperatures have crossed the critical 0.5°C threshold commonly associated with the onset of El Nino. International agencies estimate 80-90 per cent chance of the phenomenon developing through June and July and potentially peaking between November and January.

OCEANIC PATTERNS

The equatorial Pacific has transitioned rapidly from neutral conditions towards a clear El Nino pattern. While oceanic signals have strengthened, atmospheric responses typically lag and may take more time to fully develop. Even so, evolving El Nino conditions can begin influencing global weather patterns, including the monsoon.

EV bus registrations dip 7 per cent in May

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India’s electric bus registrations declined 7.2 per cent month-on-month in May, reflecting persistent infrastructure and financing bottlenecks in the country’s public transport electrification push even as JBM Auto emerged the strongest performer with a sharp jump in deployments.

According to VAHAN portal data, total electric bus registrations fell to 322 units in May from 347 units in April. However, beneath the modest market decline, competitive positions shifted sharply across manufacturers, highlighting the uneven and deployment-led nature of the EV bus market.

JBM IN LEAD

JBM Auto recorded the strongest growth during the month, with registrations rising to 157 units in May from 62 units in April, helping the company capture 48.8 per cent market share and emerge the market leader.

Commenting on the performance, Nishant Arya, Vice-Chairman and Managing Director, JBM Auto, said the company’s growth reflected its long-term focus on sustainable public mobility.

“At JBM Auto, we are building solutions that combine innovation, efficiency, and user-centric design,” Arya added.

The sharp increase points to strong execution of fleet

deployment orders and highlights how India’s electric bus market is increasingly becoming an execution-led business where deployment capability matters as much as manufacturing scale.

PMI Electro Mobility, which led the market in April, saw registrations decline to 50 units in May from 111 units a month earlier, with its market share falling to 15.5 per cent.

Switch Mobility retained a relatively stable presence with 54 registrations in May compared with 62 units in April, while Olectra Greentech rebounded sharply to 47 registrations from just one unit in the previous month, taking its market share to 14.6 per cent.

The data also showed steep decline for several players. Pinnacle Mobility’s registrations dropped to five units from 52 in April, while Aeroagle fell to three units from 28. Tata Motors remained marginal in the segment with two registrations during the month.

Industry executives said electric bus deployments are constrained by charging infrastructure and financing hurdles rather than vehicle availability alone.

The high upfront cost of electric buses continues to weigh on adoption. Private fleet operators executing gross cost contract projects often lack large fixed land assets that banks typically require as collateral to extend low-cost financing.

TVS Motor unveils premium retail channel ‘TVS Paddock’

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Motor Company, part of TVS VENU, on Saturday announced TVS Paddock, an exclusive retail channel dedicated to premium portfolio.

This strategic initiative marks a milestone in the company’s premium mobility journey, bringing together immersive brand engagement, personalised service and aftersales support under one retail ecosystem.

BRAND ENGAGEMENT

TVS Paddock is to be launched in Q2 FY27 as an exclusive premium retail channel to deliver a bespoke customer experience, reflecting the brand’s heritage, craftsmanship and premium positioning, said a release. Designed by Checkland Kindleysides, a boutique retail design agency of London, TVS Paddock meets the evolving needs and aspirations of premium motorcycle enthusiasts.

The retail network reimagines the customer journey — from first interaction to ownership. Each outlet is crafted to deliver a seamless, elevated experience that combines product discovery, expert consultation, community engagement and world-class service, the release said.

Sudarshan Venu, Chairman, TVS Motor Company, said, “As premium motorcycle customers continue to evolve, seeking deeper, holistic engagement, TVS Paddock will cater to these aspirations and deliver a truly elevated brand experience.”

G Square looks to sell industrial plots worth ₹2,000 cr this fiscal

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

G Square Group, Chennai-based real estate developer, is reviving industrial plot development after nearly five years with plans to sell properties worth around ₹2,000 crore in this fiscal. In the residential side, it plans to sell plots worth around ₹5,000 crore, Bala Ramajayam, Founder and Managing Director, G Square, told *businessline* on the sidelines of the launch of a G Square Kshetra project at Karanodai, off the Chennai-Kolkata highway.

On Saturday, the company launched an industrial plot development in Gum-

udipoondi bordering Andhra Pradesh. It also plans to soon launch an industrial plot development in Coimbatore, he said.

In FY26 fiscal, the company sold residential properties, including plots, villas and apartments, worth ₹4,000 crore, Ramajayam said. G Square Group has over 20,000 customers and has aggregated more than 5,000 acres in various places, including Chennai and Coimbatore, he added. “We could not sell industrial plots in the last five years due to various reasons, including lack of support from the government,” said Ramajayam. “However, this year we are bullish on this sector,” he said, adding that the new State government is giving all support for this sector.

SAS ‘working with Delhi’ to restart flights to India

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Scandinavian Airlines (SAS) is working closely with New Delhi to commence operations to India, the airline has said.

On Tuesday, SAS’s re-launch flight from Copenhagen to Mumbai had to turn back as it did not have regulatory clearance from India.

In a new statement, the airline said it is fully committed to operating in compliance with all applicable requirements.

“We appreciate the constructive dialogue and ongoing efforts of the DGCA and the relevant authorities throughout this process,” the airline said.

“India is an important market for SAS, and we remain fully committed to the Copenhagen-Mumbai service and successfully connecting the Scandinavian and Indian regions with seamless options,” the airline added.

The airline is looking to commence service to India after 17 years.

Kalyani wealth case: Court refuses to stay Sugandha Hiremath’s plea

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

A Pune court has refused to stay the hearing in the partition suit filed by Sugandha Hiremath seeking her share in the Kalyani family wealth.

Her younger brother Gaurishankar Kalyani and his daughter Sheetal Kalyani had filed an application under Section 10 of the Civil Procedure Code seeking to stay the proceedings on the grounds that Hiremath’s suit was similar to other suits filed seeking Kalyani family wealth partition.

In two separate orders passed on June 3, Joint Civil Judge JG Pawar refused to stay the proceedings on Hiremath’s petition. The court took note of four suits concerning Kalyani family wealth. This included Sheetal’s suit, one filed by Hiremath’s children Sameer and Pallavi, and two suits filed by Hiremath in 2012 and 2025.

The court observed that



in each of the four suits, parties were not same, prayers are not identical, cause of action are on different footings, properties in all four suits are not identical, among other things.

NON-IDENTICAL SUITS

“Therefore, all these suits are not identical on the point of capacity of parties, title under whom they are litigating with each other. As such, the decision of each suit would not operate *res judicata* against other suits. Therefore, the matter in issue in present suit is not directly and substantially in issue in previously pending 3 suits,” stated the order.

Sugandha Hiremath, sister of industrialists Baba Kalyani and Gaurishankar Kalyani had filed the suit seeking partition of family wealth in 2025. The suit alleged that her brothers control promoter shares of all Kalyani group companies. She alleged that all these years, the two have been selling, transferring and alienating the shares.

LEGACY WEALTH

The suit claims all the wealth that exists with any member of Kalyani family was created from the nucleus. Her grandfather Anappa Narayan Kalyani (ANK) was the one who created the initial wealth which got passed down.

The wealth left behind by ANK was passed down to his son, Neelkanth Kalyani, who was doyen of industry in the country, and he created several flagship companies under the Kalyani group banner. After his passing, his sons Baba Kalyani and Gaurishankar Kalyani took over most of the companies under the Kalyani group banner.

VOC Port signs up with H2Global for clean ship fuel

Our Bureau
Chennai

V. O. Chidambaranar Port Authority in Thoothukudi has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Germany’s H2Global, represented by the H2Global Foundation and Hintco GmbH, to explore cooperation in the development of green hydrogen and clean shipping fuel trade corridors.

The MoU will focus on assessing the role of port infrastructure in supporting clean fuel production and offtake, while examining implementation pathways for integrating Indian ports into international green fuel supply chains.

The areas of cooperation include assessment of infrastructure and logistics requirements for storage, handling, bunkering, transport, certification, market creation, safety and export of green fuels, including green ammonia, green methanol and other hydrogen derivatives, said a release.

Cockroach Janta Party protests in Delhi seeking Pradhan’s resignation

Our Bureau
New Delhi

As scheduled, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), an outfit yet to be registered as a political party, held its first protest on Saturday at Jantar Mantar, New Delhi’s permitted protest site.

The event drew college-goers, job aspirants, new employees and parents, among others. While the group was able to highlight its key demand — the resignation or sacking of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan — without getting distracted by other issues, the overall turnout did not live up to the social media hype.

Many elderly participants at the protest site in the blazing heat said their presence was only to support the cause even though it was primarily driven by Gen Z. On the other hand, there were a few to “protest against the protest” and did not hesitate to disclose their intention.

MASS SUPPORT

Even with its low scale participation, the visuals, including videos from the protest site were all over the social media throughout the day and it helped the organisers highlight the issue of failure of the examination system the past few years. Participants raised slogans seeking political accountability over alleged irregularities in examinations and recruit-



Abhijeet Dipke, Head of the CJP, addresses the protest at Delhi’s Jantar Mantar on Saturday **SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA**

ment processes and not “bureaucratic excuses.”

A lot of people were seen wearing cockroach merchandise, T-Shirts and banners with slogans like “Jai Bhim”, “Godi Media Murdabad” and “Dharmendra Pradhan isteefa do”.

Amid presence of the media, protestors started gathering at the site since morning while leaders were seen announcing to wait till arrival of Abhijeet Dipke, founder of CJP.

After arriving at Indira Gandhi International Airport at around 10 in the morning, Dipke drove to the protest venue amid tight security as hundreds of people had reached the airport to receive him.

Addressing the protestors, Dipke criticised the government for focussing on the organisation’s social media activity rather than addressing issues, including demand for the resignation of Pradhan over alleged irregularities in examinations and recruitment tests. But he urged his supporters to

maintain discipline and ensure that the protest remains peaceful.

“My friends, this is a long struggle. It has been a month since we started demanding Pradhan’s resignation on social media, but these individuals are so shameless that instead of taking action, they have been focused on other distractions, like hacking our accounts and getting our posts deleted. You may be able to delete our posts, but you cannot erase us from this space,” said Dipke.

WANGCHUK JOINS

Ladakh’s former BJP MP Sonam Wangchuk, who has since quit the party, also attended the protest and extended his support to CJP. He even announced a six-week sit-in if Dipke was arrested. CPI(ML) general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, CPI’s Annie Raja and student leaders of Left-leaning organisations also participated in the protest, which ended around 3:30 pm after Dipke started feeling unwell.

‘Nutraceutical boom colliding with supply-chain, restocking pressures’

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India’s nutraceutical market may be racing toward a government-backed \$100-billion target by 2030, but executives from Dabur India, Himalaya Wellness, and former P&G leadership warn that the industry’s supply-chain backbone is struggling to keep pace with exploding demand, fragmented retail networks, and rising SKU complexity.

Executives from Dabur India, Himalaya Wellness and former P&G leadership, speaking at an industry panel discussion titled ‘Can Supply Chain Build the Nutra Business?’, warned that India’s nutraceutical boom is colliding with growing supply-chain and replenishment pressures across the country’s fragmented retail ecosystem.

WIDTH VS DEPTH

The concern, industry leaders say, is that India’s well-

ness economy has driven consumer demand far faster than the country has scaled its replenishment infrastructure — creating mounting stress across warehousing, cold-chain logistics, forecasting, and retail distribution systems as wellness consumption spreads deeper into Tier-2 and Tier-3 markets.

“Core is not about being present. Core is about replenishment,” said Siddharth Vachaspati, former Country Sales Director at P&G, arguing that many nutraceutical brands are still confusing store listings with sustainable retail velocity.

Industry veterans said many brands are optimising for “distribution width, the number of stores carrying a product, rather than “distribution depth,” or how consistently those stores are actually reordering inventory.

At Himalaya Wellness, executives describe the challenge as uniquely Indian in

scale and fragmentation. “India is a complex number — yes, it’s one country, but it is a market of mega screens,” said Vikas Bansil, Business Director, Himalaya Wellness.

SPEED DISCOVERY

Executives say Indian consumers now discover wellness products at algorithmic speed through Instagram, influencers, and quick-commerce platforms, while much of the backend retail ecosystem still relies on fragmented distributor networks, low-visibility kirana systems, and delayed replenishment cycles.

That mismatch is forcing brands to simultaneously operate like premium digital wellness companies in metro markets while supplying low-ticket sachets and strip packs to small-town retail networks.

“What works in a Tier-1 city doesn’t work in a Tier-3 town,” said Sriram Padmanabhan, Business Unit Director at Dabur India.

SpaceX inks three-year \$30-billion computing power deal with Google

Bloomberg

Alphabet Inc’s Google has agreed to pay Elon Musk’s SpaceX \$920 million a month for computing power as part of a cloud services deal that runs through mid-2029, its second such agreement with an AI competitor in a matter of weeks.

Google will pay SpaceX the monthly fee from October this year through June 2029, SpaceX said in the filing Friday. That amounts to about \$30 billion through the time of the agreement.

If SpaceX fails to deliver access to Nvidia Corp chips as part of the deal by September 30, Google has the right to terminate the contract, with a one-month grace period, the filing shows. A Google Cloud spokesperson said the deal would help the company meet demand for its AI services. In its most recent earnings report, Alphabet said Google Cloud’s backlog — the measure of contracted work that hasn’t been recorded as revenue yet — nearly doubled from the prior quarter to more than \$460 billion.

‘BRIDGE CAPACITY’

“This is a short-term, timely agreement to ensure we have bridge capacity to meet surging customer demand for our agent platform, Gemini Enterprise, which has been even higher than we expected,” the Google spokesperson said in a statement.

The contract gives Google access to 110,000 of Nvidia’s graphics processing unit chips, as well as central processing unit



chips, memory chips and other related components. Based on the capacity of Nvidia’s H200 chips, that may represent well over 100 megawatts of computing power — or enough power to energise 75,000 homes at any given moment.

The cloud deal isn’t the only pact that Google and SpaceX have been engaged in talks over. The two companies have been discussing launching the search company’s test products for orbital data centres, a person familiar with the matter said in May.

Under the pact disclosed on Friday, either party also has the right to terminate the arrangement with 90 days’ notice — the same feature as in Anthropic’s deal.

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